MARKET & FEATURE REPORT · OCTOBER 2026

VIDEOBOY

The analog instrument in a digital market.

A checked inventory of what Videoboy does; how it compares with Resolume, VDMX, Millumin, QLab, MadMapper, TouchDesigner, Synesthesia, the DJ video tools, vMix, ATEM, DaVinci Resolve, Premiere Pro and Logic Pro; what broadcast and DJing can teach it; the owner's roadmap; and what I would do next.

Videoboy 0.4.10 · branch feature/queue-names · research date 2026-10-01

Prepared by Claude (Anthropic) for Spencer Starnes · © NewVHS / Spencer Starnes 2026

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HOW TO READ THE TABLES

● offered ◐ partial / indirect — not offered, or not found in the docs reviewed

? not verified n/a not applicable

Videoboy claims are checked against the code. 130 features were read from the source, not from the documents (two of which are out of date), each with an evidence path. Every path was tested for existence by script and the status counts are machine counts. A second read corrected three rows and added three.

Market claims are sourced. Vendor documentation and price pages were fetched on 2026-10-01. Figures from secondary sites are marked *****. Anything not checked is shown as **?**, not guessed.

Prices are in the vendor's currency (€, $, £) and are not converted. Subscriptions are annualised as monthly × 12 where no yearly price is published.

Opinion is labelled. The market map's positions, the interface ratings and the "what I would do" section are the author's view; the roadmap is the owner's.

Scope. DMX and lighting are left out, as asked. No competitor was installed or tested hands-on; no market-size figure is given because none could be sourced reliably.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A real instrument with no rival in its lane, and five gaps between it and a bigger room.

1 **Nobody else does what the wedge does.**
Live datamosh on a real H.264 stream, an NTSC composite signal model, the AVE-5 wipe block and a real Scala titler as a source: none of the 14 products in the comparison matrices offers any of them as a built-in feature.

2 **It already speaks broadcast.**
Hot Punch, A/B ROLL, ADV, bus keys, tally and one-take ISO recording are switcher behaviour. VJ tools don't have it; ATEM and vMix do, without the beat.

3 **The gaps are plumbing, not looks.**
OSC, Syphon / NDI, MIDI clock / Link, timecode and undo are standard in the live competitors and absent here. Each is days of work, not weeks.

4 **Inside a clip, Videoboy is blind.**
One in/out pair per clip. Every DJ app, Resolume, QLab and MadMapper can mark and jump to points inside media. Hot cues are the single biggest performance gap.

5 **Live video still sells licences; DJ and editing software increasingly rent.**
Resolume €299 / €799, VDMX $199 / $349, Synesthesia $199 / $399 — all one-time. rekordbox, VirtualDJ and Premiere lead with subscriptions, and Apple bundled its pro apps at $129 a year in January 2026.

FEATURES INVENTORIED
130
85 shipped · 10 partial · 2 off · 33 absent

PRODUCTS COMPARED
14
7 live tools + 7 adjacent (DJ, switchers, editors, DAW)

SWIFT
80k
lines in 252 files; Core has 867 tests, 0 failures

SELF-QA CHECKS
40
offscreen PNG, analog loopback, virtual MIDI

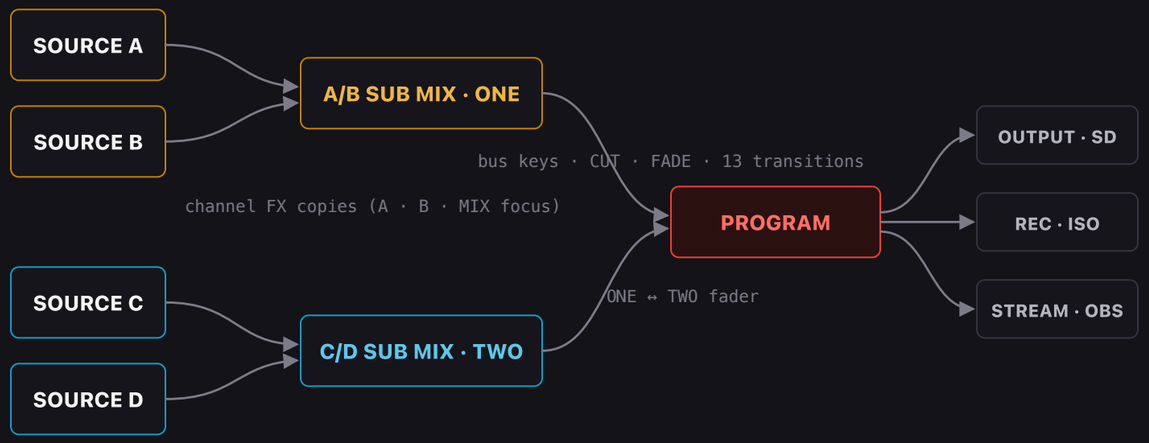
MEAN FRAME AT FULL LOAD
6.4 ms
of a 33.4 ms budget (29.97 fps)

HD SOAK, 10 MINUTES
0
dropped frames; memory flat; 0 leaks

Sources: feature-inventory.md (code-checked) · competitor documentation listed in the appendix

WHAT IT IS

A four-channel live mixer that breaks the bitstream on the beat.



The wedge

Musical, playable manipulation of compressed video bitstreams (MPEG family), output clean to SD for an analog chain. Everything else is supporting cast (CLAUDE.md).

The canvas

SD NTSC 720×480 at 29.97 is the default and the reference. PAL, HD, square and vertical are approved for 0.4.11, not built yet.

The rules

Smooth playback outranks every feature. The app is silent: audio comes in only to find the beat. A/B always feed ONE and C/D always feed TWO.

The build

Native AppKit + Metal, Apple Silicon only. About 80,000 lines of Swift in 252 files; a headless Core with 867 tests; 40 named self-QA checks.

FRAME BUDGET

33.4 ms

one frame at 29.97

FULL-LOAD MEAN

6.4 ms

stress test, all four channels, every effect (09-28)

WORST TICK

17.8 ms

stress worst; GPU-fence stalls still under study

10-MIN HD SOAK

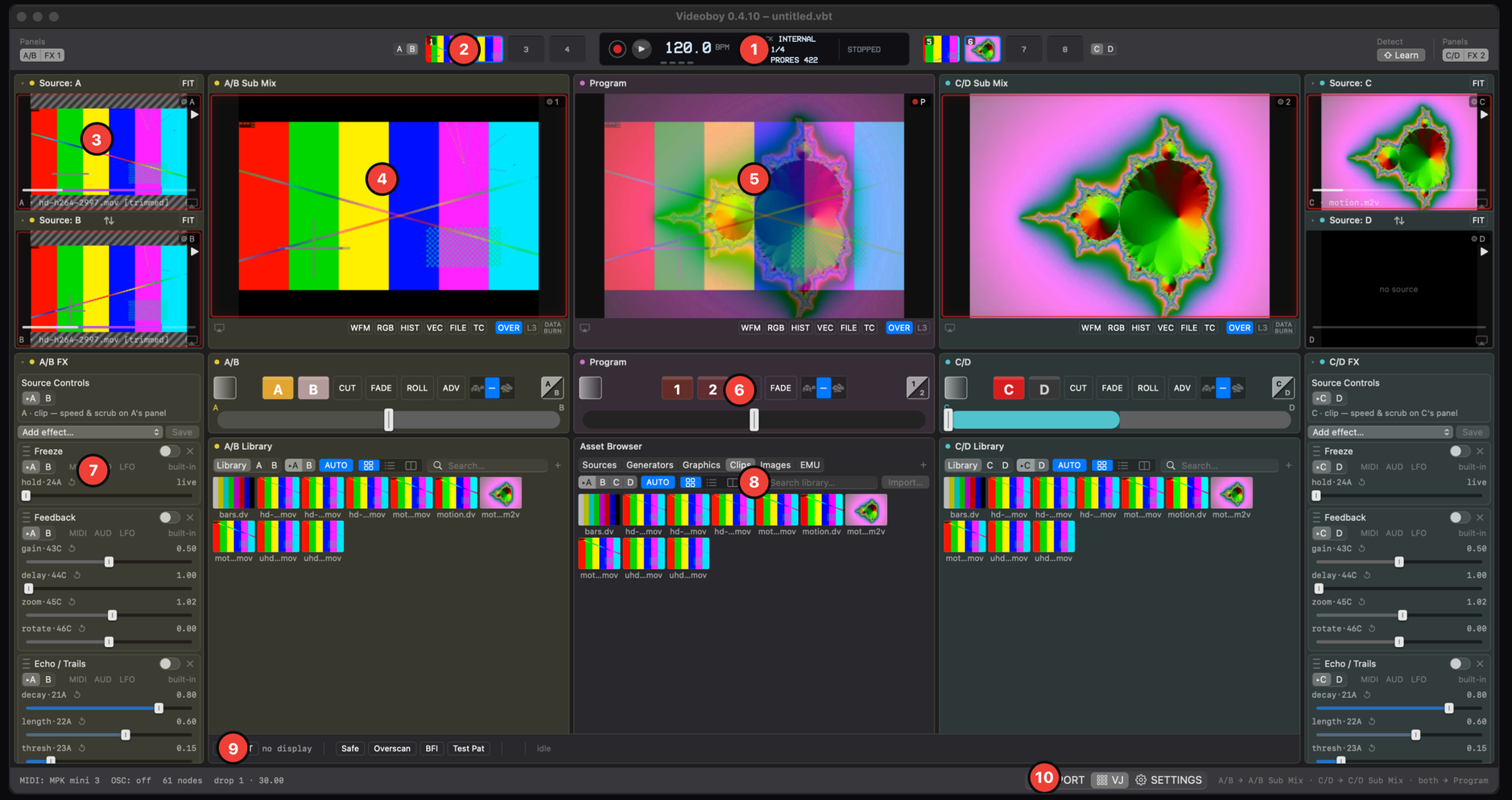
0 dropped

2× 1080p H.264 + ProRes + 4K HEVC, memory flat

Sources: CLAUDE.md · docs/SPEC.md §2 · docs/AUDIT-2026-09-28.md · Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/VideoboyCore.swift (0.4.10)

THE INTERFACE TODAY

One fixed window. Everything within reach.



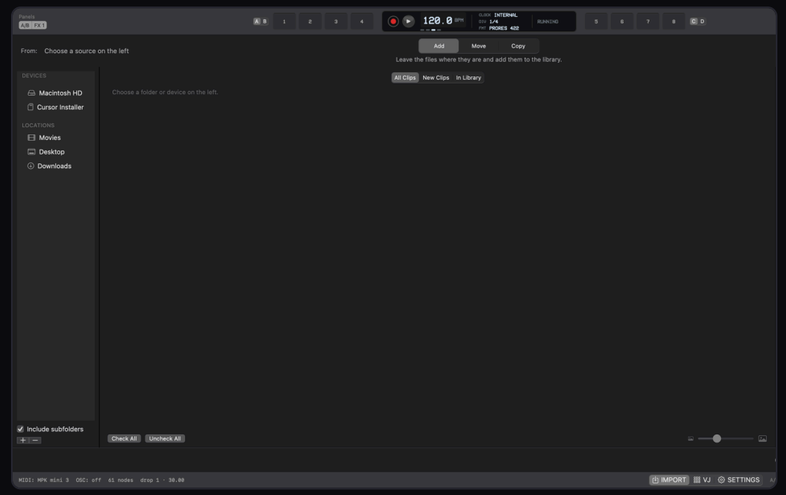
1. **Transport cluster**
   BPM, CLOCK, DIV, FMT, record, play; Learn, Detect and Hot Punch at the edges
2. **Clip Pads 1–8**
   whole-clip launchers with A/B · C/D side switches; ⌥ loads + cuts, ⌥⌘ on the beat
3. **Sources A–D**
   preview, shuttle, scrub, loop mode, FIT
4. **Sub Mix monitors**
   ONE and TWO with WFM · RGB · HIST · VEC · FILE · TC · OVER · L3 · DATA BURN
5. **Program**
   the output, with tally
6. **Bus rows**
   A·B / 1·2 / C·D keys, CUT, FADE, ROLL, ADV, transition and blend keys, DJ-style faders
7. **FX panels**
   A · B · MIX focus, Source Controls, cards with MIDI · AUD · LFO badges
8. **Libraries + Asset Browser**
   Sources, Generators, Graphics, Clips, Images, EMU; icon, list and column views
9. **Output bar**
   OUTPUT, Safe, Overscan, BFI, Test Pat
10. **Mode bar + status**
    IMPORT · VJ · SETTINGS (⌘1–3); MIDI, OSC, node count, drops, fps

Screenshot: selfqa/out/perf/pads/window.png — the real window, captured by the self-QA harness on 2026-09-28

MODES

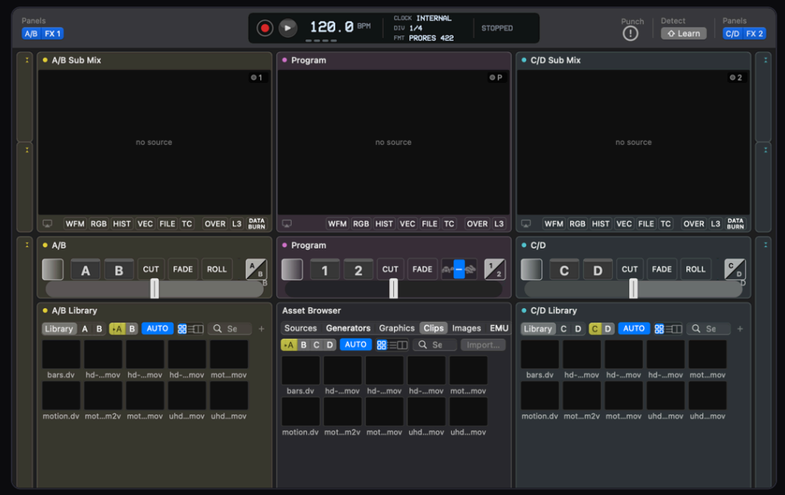
Three rooms, one engine that never stops.

IMPORT · ⌘1



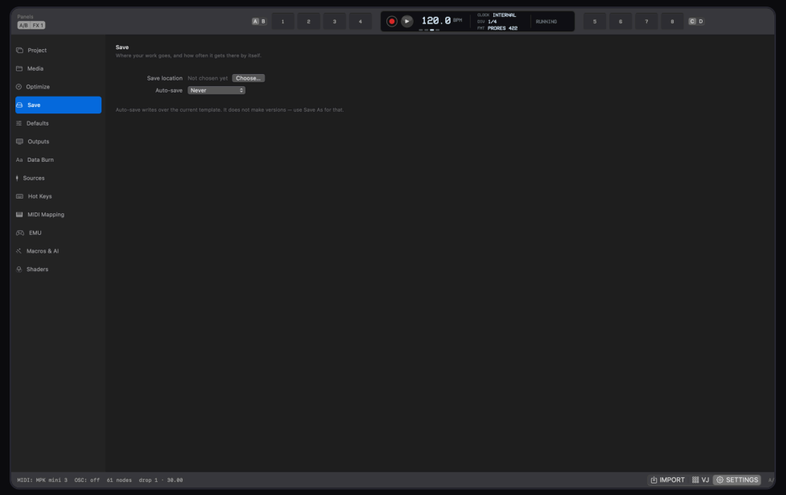
Lightroom Classic's model: devices and locations, a checkable grid, Add · Move · Copy, duplicates skipped, choose a bin, optional Copy + Optimize into linked MPEG-2 GOP 6 media.

VJ · ⌘2 — COMPACT WIDTH



The performance window. It is width-reactive: at compact widths the sources and FX panels fold to rails; at narrow widths only Program, the faders and the output bar stay.

SETTINGS · ⌘3



A mode, not a dialog: 13 panes, from Project, Media and Optimize to Hot Keys, MIDI Mapping, EMU, Macros & AI and Shaders.

Never interrupts

Switching modes keeps the engine rendering; output and recording continue.

Discoverable

⌘1–⌘3 are View-menu items, so they can be remapped in System Settings.

Separate player

Import's viewer has its own player; auditioning never touches Program.

Fixed, not frozen

Panels collapse and the grid reflows at three breakpoints; nothing ever moves position.

Screenshots: selfqa/out/perf/modes/*.png, selfqa/out/phase-2/ui-layout/compact.png · docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-26.md §4–5 · SPEC §14.4

FEATURE INVENTORY

Everything Videoboy does today, checked against the code.

85 shipped · 10 partial · 2 built but switched off · 33 not built — 130 rows, every evidence path tested by script.

● shipped, on by default ◐ partial ⚑ built, flag off — not built page 1 of 5

#	FEATURE (CHECKED IN THE CODE)	STATUS	EVIDENCE
A · PLATFORM AND ENGINE			
A1	Native macOS app, AppKit + Metal, Apple Silicon (arm64) only	●	CLAUDE.md, App/Sources/Videoboy/Render/Engine.swift
A2	Core logic as a headless, unit-tested SwiftPM package (867 tests, 0 failures on 2026-10-01)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore, scripts/test.sh
A3	Render graph: 4 channels → 2 sub-mix buses → Program (A/B→ONE, C/D→TWO fixed)	●	docs/SPEC.md §2, Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Graph
A4	Frame-clocked engine, renders once per 29.97 content frame from a screen display link	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/Render/Engine.swift
A5	Decode ahead on per-clip queues; tick never waits more than 5 ms (holds last picture)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/ClipPrefetcher.swift
A6	Measured full-load stress: mean 6.4 ms / worst 17.8 ms; 10-min HD soak 0 dropped frames	●	docs/AUDIT-2026-09-28.md
A7	Feature flags with env override (VIDEOBOY_FLAGS)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/VideoboyCore.swift
A8	Param-code addressing: every control has a stable code (e.g. 24A); mappings survive module swaps	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Control/ParamCode.swift, Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Control/Param…
A9	One extension seam (Node protocol + manifest), documented recipe	●	docs/ADD-A-MODULE.md, Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/_Template/ExampleNode.swift
A10	Project canvas: SD NTSC 720×480 @ 29.97 only today	◐	other canvases are planned for 0.4.11 (docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-26.md §6)
A11	Launch window listing what loads (Adobe/Logic style)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/LaunchWindowController.swift
A12	Self-QA harness: 40 named checks (offscreen PNG, DVC100 loopback, virtual MIDI)	●	scripts/selfqa.sh, docs/SELF-QA-HARNESS.md
B · SOURCES (WHAT CAN BE LOADED INTO A / B / C / D)			
B1	Ordinary video files via AVFoundation (.mov/.mp4, H.264, HEVC incl. hev1, ProRes)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/AVFClipDecoder.swift, Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/…
B2	MPEG-family files through the bitstream decoder (libav, LGPL) so the wedge has packets to damage	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/MPEGStreamDecoder.swift
B3	DV files	—	DV path removed 2026-09-28 (git log ad14e29, c5786d9)
B4	Photo folder / image sequence as ONE beat-locked clip (SEQ, a frame per quarter note)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/ImageSequenceDecoder.swift
B5	13 native generators (Solid, Linear/Radial Gradient, Checkerboard, Stripes, Grid, Rings, White Noise, Noise Field, Difference Clouds, Halftone, Scanlines, Now Playing)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/GeneratorSourceNode.swift
B6	ISF generators from the shared ISF folders (~/Library/Graphics/ISF, VDMX's)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Effects/ISF, App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/GeneratorThumbnails…
B7	Test pattern source (SMPTE-style bars etc.)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/TestPatternSourceNode.swift, App/Sources/Videobo…
B8	Camera / capture card via AVFoundation (webcams, Continuity Camera, UVC)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/LiveAVFoundationCapture.swift
B9	Window capture via ScreenCaptureKit (pick a window)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/WindowCaptureSource.swift
B10	Configured sources list (Settings ▸ Sources, + / −)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/SourceListView.swift
B11	IP camera / NDI / RTSP / SRT input	—	listed greyed in Settings ▸ Sources; no decoder
B12	DV deck (FireWire) input	—	greyed placeholder

Feature inventory, continued

● shipped, on by default ◐ partial ⚑ built, flag off — not built page 2 of 5

#	FEATURE (CHECKED IN THE CODE)	STATUS	EVIDENCE
B13	DVC100 as a live source (not just self-QA loopback)	—	docs/BUILD-PLAN.md backlog
B14	Emulated titler: real Scala MM400 on Amiberry (Kickstart 3.1), out-of-process, genlock key	◐	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Emu/EmulatedTitlerNode.swift; key colour/threshold/edg…
B15	Native Core Text character generator	◐	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Titler/CharacterGeneratorNode.swift; node built, **not …
B16	Now Playing overlay (Apple Music + Spotify; three looks; fades on change)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Titler/NowPlayingRenderer.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/Pl…
B17	SVG / PS1-style source	—	docs/SPEC.md §17, not started
B18	Audio playback of clips	—	by design: the app outputs no audio (docs/SPEC.md §21)
C · PER-CHANNEL PLAYBACK (THE SHUTTLE)			
C1	Play / stop per source, preview per source	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/PanelBodies.swift
C2	Loop · Ping-Pong · One Shot	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/ClipSourceNode.swift
C3	Scrub track and frame step	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/VBMiniPlayBar.swift
C4	STEP playback locked to the beat (a frame per 8 bars … per 1/16), click faster / right-click slower	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/ClipSourceNode.swift (slowLadder, fastLadder), A…
C5	Playback speed parameter	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/ClipSourceNode.swift (playbackSpeed)
C6	In / out marks (stored in the catalog, trim playback)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Persistence/Catalog.swift
C7	Fit · Fill · Stretch · Centre per source (FIT key)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/PreviewFill.swift
C8	Queue per channel (Play Next to the front, Play Last to the end; saved with the show)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Sources/ClipQueue.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/QueueVi…
C9	A/B ROLL (roll the taken source, re-cue the leaving one) + ADV (load the next clip)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Control/ABRoll.swift, docs/specs/ab-roll-adv.md
C10	Hot cues / cue points inside a clip (DJ-style)	—	no cue-point model; only one in/out pair per clip
C11	Reverse play as a key, time-remapping curves	—	reverse only via Ping-Pong
C12	Beat-quantised loop lengths inside a clip (loop roll, beat jump)	—	—
D · LIBRARY, CATALOG AND IMPORT			
D1	SQLite catalog (Lightroom model), WAL, single writer queue, weekly backup	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Persistence/Catalog.swift
D2	Bookmarks so moved/renamed files can be found (relink in the model)	◐	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Persistence/Catalog.swift; no Relink… command found in the UI
D3	Nested bins; imports keep the folder tree	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/BinsSelfQA.swift
D4	Icon / list / column views (Finder model), path bar, multi-select, drag anywhere, ⌘C/⌘V/⌘⌫	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/LibraryGridView.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/LibraryListView.swi…
D5	Hover-scrub thumbnails with real decoded frames	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/LibraryItemView.swift
D6	Search	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/LibraryBrowser.swift
D7	Background import job + contextual status bar (1,000 clips mid-show, 0 dropped)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/ImportJob.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/ImportSelfQA.swift
D8	Import mode (⌘1): Devices / Locations, Add · Move · Copy, duplicates skipped, bin choice, J/K/L viewer, I/O marks	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/ImportModeView.swift
D9	Copy + Optimize: linked optimized media (MPEG-2 GOP 6 on SD), playback prefers it	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/OptimizeQueue.swift, docs/specs/0.4.10-copy-optimize.md
D10	Per-panel libraries (A/B and C/D) + central Asset Browser (Sources · Generators · Graphics · Clips · Images · EMU)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/LibraryPanelBody.swift
D11	Tags, smart bins, colour labels in use, energy fader	—	planned 0.5.0 (docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-26.md appendix A)
D12	Saved Playlists and Setlists, Lists tab	—	planned (docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-28-setlist.md)
D13	Catalog export to JSON	—	proposed, not found in code

Source: docs/research/2026-10-01/feature-inventory.md · branch feature/queue-names a92f464

Feature inventory, continued

● shipped, on by default ◐ partial ⚑ built, flag off — not built page 3 of 5

#	FEATURE (CHECKED IN THE CODE)	STATUS	EVIDENCE
E · MIXING, CUTTING AND TRANSITIONS			
E1	Three crossfaders: A↔B, C↔D, ONE↔TWO (custom DJ-style VBFader)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/VBFader.swift, Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Mix/CrossfadeNode…
E2	CUT and FADE keys, beat-quantised, with their own rates	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Mix/FadeAutomation.swift
E3	Bus keys (A / B, C / D, 1 / 2) take a source to air	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/VBBusButton.swift
E4	13 blend modes (Normal … Soft Light) + Key	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Mix/BlendMode.swift
E5	13 transition patterns: Dissolve, Wipe H/V, Slide H/V, Push H/V, Iris, Split H/V, Interlace H/V, AVE-5	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Mix/Transition.swift
E6	Panasonic WJ-AVE5 wipe block (31 patterns, MULTI, border/soft edge, back colour, joystick)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Mix/AVE5Wipe.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/AVE5WipePane…
E7	Clip Pads: 8 launchers (1–4 A/B, 5–8 C/D), pre-opened, ⌥ load+play+cut, ⌥⌘ on the beat	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Control/ClipPadBank.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/ClipPadView.s…
E8	Hot Punch (!): pad press goes straight to Program	●	docs/specs/clip-pads.md, App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/PadsSelfQA.swift
E9	Preview/Program (PVW/PGM) on separate buses with a take	◐	sub-mix monitors act as preview; there is no dedicated PVW bus or AUTO/TAKE pair
E10	Soft-edge / border width on ordinary wipes	—	docs/BUILD-PLAN.md ("Not yet")
E11	Layer mask, picture-in-picture box, split screen as a layer	—	Layer Mask in backlog; AVE-5 P-IN-P drawn disabled
E12	Upstream/downstream keyers as separate layers (DSK)	—	only the Key blend mode on a fader
E13	Per-source crop, anchor point and a visible opacity fader	—	layer opacity 66A exists with no fader (Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Control/ParamCode.swi…
F · EFFECTS			
F1	Datamosh · H.264 (live I-frame removal, P-frame bloom, MOSH hold, HEAL with shapes, heal on the beat)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Effects/DatamoshNode.swift, docs/DATAMOSH.md
F2	Composite · NTSC (encode→decode, dot crawl, chroma bleed, TBC wobble, head switching, generation loss, S-Video path)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Effects/CompositeCodecNode.swift
F3	Feedback (frame delay, gain, zoom, rotate, luma key)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Effects/FeedbackNode.swift
F4	Freeze (hold)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Effects/FreezeNode.swift
F5	Echo / Trails	●	App/Resources/ISF/Builtin/Echo.fs
F6	Transform: scale, position X/Y, rotation, flip H/V (no crop, anchor or 3-D rotation)	●	App/Resources/ISF/Builtin/Transform.fs
F7	Colour: brightness, contrast, saturation, shadow, highlight, black, white, gamma	●	App/Resources/ISF/Builtin/Colour.fs
F8	ISF import: any ISF effect/generator dropped in becomes a card (shared + app folders)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Effects/ISF, App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/ISFModuleListView.s…
F9	Effect chain per FX panel, reorderable cards (Photoshop-layer order), one A · B · MIX focus	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/EffectChainPanelBody.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/FXFocusS…
F10	MPEG bitstream corruptor (the wedge's damage card)	⚑	built and tested; bitstreamCorruptor flag OFF by owner decision
F11	NTSC output emulation toggle on the output bar	⚑	outputSignalEmulation flag OFF
F12	FFGL plug-ins, Core Image / AU passthrough	—	docs/SPEC.md §8–9, not started
F13	Macroblock-level motion-vector editing on MPEG-2	—	deferred (docs/BUILD-PLAN.md)
F14	Per-effect presets / effect snapshots	◐	whole-show save works; single-chain preset keys still open
G · MODULATION, AUTOMATION AND THE CLOCK			
G1	Transport: BPM, play/stop, phase, subdivisions (1/1 … 1/16, dotted, triplet)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Clock/Transport.swift
G2	Latency compensation (schedule at T – latency), unit-tested	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Clock
G3	Tap tempo	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/VBTempoField.swift
G4	Beat detection with BeatNet (ported network) from system audio, an audio input, or ONE app's audio (Core Audio process taps)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Audio/BeatNet, App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/SystemAudioTap.swif…
G5	LFO on any effect parameter: 7 shapes, subdivision or free Hz, depth, phase, polarity, invert	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Clock/LFO.swift

Source: docs/research/2026-10-01/feature-inventory.md · branch feature/queue-names a92f464

Feature inventory, continued

● shipped, on by default ◐ partial ⚑ built, flag off — not built page 4 of 5

#	FEATURE (CHECKED IN THE CODE)	STATUS	EVIDENCE
G6	Audio-reactivity bus (RMS, bands, onsets) → any effect parameter	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Audio/AudioReactivityBus.swift
G7	⌥⌘ beat sweeps on faders and parameters (automation sampled at presentation time)	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Control/ParameterSweep.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/Push…
G8	Driven-parameter marks (outline breathes on the beat)	●	docs/DESIGN-BACKLOG.md "Done in this pass"
G9	Manual BPM entry, ×2 / ÷2, downbeat ("one") finding, nudge/offset	◐	tempo field present; ×2/÷2 and bar-finding not built (docs/BUILD-PLAN.md)
G10	MIDI clock in/out, Ableton Link	—	removed from CLOCK as unbuilt (App/Sources/Videoboy/Render/Engine.swift comment)
G11	Timeline / cue-list automation (record a performance, play it back)	—	—
G12	Calibrated feedback latency (measured 3 frames / 100 ms)	◐	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Modules/Effects/FeedbackLatencyCalibrator.swift; measured, not …
G13	Timecode sync (SMPTE LTC / MTC)	—	no implementation; TC is shown and burned in, not followed
G14	Sync to DJ hardware (Pro DJ Link / StageLinQ)	—	song linking to Apple Music is planned instead (docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-28-setlist.md §6)
H · CONTROL			
H1	Core MIDI in: Note, CC, pitch bend; any velocity counts as a press	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Control/MIDIInput.swift
H2	Shift-to-detect MIDI learn on every enabled control; Esc cancels, ⌫ unmaps	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/DetectSession.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/UndoSelfQA.swift
H3	MIDI mapping pane (remove one at a time)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/PreferencePanes.swift
H4	Every beat-rate key follows one rule (click faster, right-click slower) — 93 keys	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/VBStepButton.swift
H5	Hot keys pane; number keys fire pads	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/PreferencePanes.swift
H6	14-bit CC, NRPN, MIDI out (LED feedback to controllers), controller templates/fingerprinting	—	docs/STATUS.md §7
H7	OSC in/out	—	status bar reads "OSC: off"; no implementation
H8	Undo / redo (general)	—	no NSUndoManager; targeted take-backs only (App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/UndoSelfQA.swi…
H9	Macros & AI control	—	Settings pane reads "Not built yet" (App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/PreferencePanes.swift)
I · OUTPUT, MONITORING AND SCOPES			
I1	Borderless output window on any display, mode negotiated and logged	●	docs/SPEC.md §3, App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/OutputSelfQA.swift
I2	Send glyph under every preview: route Program / ONE / TWO / any source to a display; four-up tiled send	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/RoutingPopover.swift
I3	Previews for all 4 sources, both sub-mixes and Program	●	docs/mockups/layout-v6.html, selfqa/out/perf/pads/window.png
I4	Scopes: waveform, RGB parade, histogram, vectorscope, mini luma; OVER (overlay) and L3	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Scopes
I5	NTSC legality (7.5–100 IRE) reporting	●	docs/DESIGN-BACKLOG.md
I6	FILE / TC overlays and DATA BURN (burned-in timecode/file data)	●	selfqa/out/phase-2/ui-layout/data-burn-program.png
I7	Safe zones, overscan (on/off), BFI, test pattern to output	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/SettingsBarPanelBody.swift
I8	Multiviewer with tally colours	◐	the grid is a multiviewer; red outline on the on-air monitors; no tally out
I9	Projection mapping, edge blending, multi-projector warp	—	out of scope by design
I10	Syphon / NDI / virtual camera out	—	optional backlog item
I11	Overscan as a continuous control	—	docs/BUILD-PLAN.md
J · RECORDING AND STREAMING			
J1	Record Program and discrete A/B/C/D together, one folder per take	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/RecordingSession.swift
J2	Codecs: ProRes 422, ProRes HQ, ProRes 4444, H.264, HEVC	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/Platform/FrameRecorder.swift
J3	Stream to OBS: MPEG-TS over UDP, nothing to install	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Bitstream/MPEGTSStreamer.swift

Source: docs/research/2026-10-01/feature-inventory.md · branch feature/queue-names a92f464

Feature inventory, continued

● shipped, on by default ◐ partial ⚑ built, flag off — not built page 5 of 5

#	FEATURE (CHECKED IN THE CODE)	STATUS	EVIDENCE
J4	RTMP / SRT / NDI streaming	—	—
J5	Recording audio with the picture	—	the app outputs no audio
J6	Encoding off the main thread for recording/streaming	◐	audit F7/F8 open (docs/FEATURE-LEDGER-2026-09-27.md)
K · SHOWS, SETTINGS AND MODES			
K1	Show files (.vbt, plain-text JSON, template v5): New / Open / Open Recent / Save / Save As, auto-save, save-on-quit	●	Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/Persistence/TemplateDocument.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/Platfor…
K2	Mode bar: ⌘1 Import · ⌘2 VJ · ⌘3 Settings (switching never interrupts output)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/AppMode.swift, App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/ModeController.swift
K3	Settings mode, 13 panes: Project, Media, Optimize, Save, Defaults, Outputs, Data Burn, Sources, Hot Keys, MIDI Mapping, EMU, Macros & AI, Shaders	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/PreferencePanes.swift, selfqa/out/phase-2/ui-layout/preferences-*.…
K4	Setup assistant (locations, project, optimize)	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/SetupAssistant.swift
K5	Panels collapse to rails; width-reactive at three breakpoints; fixed docked grid	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/CollapsedRailView.swift, selfqa/out/phase-2/ui-layout/compact.png
K6	"Don't remind me again" suppressions, resettable	●	App/Sources/Videoboy/UI/ReminderAlert.swift
K7	Simple mode (A/B only)	—	docs/STATUS.md §2
K8	LOCK per bank	—	planned (setlist proposal §7)

Source: docs/research/2026-10-01/feature-inventory.md · branch feature/queue-names a92f464

THE HONEST LIST

What isn't there yet.

33 features are absent, 10 are partial and 2 are finished but deliberately switched off — including the bitstream corruptor the app was built around.

NOT BUILT · 33

Absent from the code: comments, greyed placeholders or nothing.

- B3 DV files
- B11 IP camera / NDI / RTSP / SRT input
- B12 DV deck (FireWire) input
- B13 DVC100 as a live source (not just self-QA loopback)
- B17 SVG / PS1-style source
- B18 Audio playback of clips
- C10 Hot cues / cue points inside a clip (DJ-style)
- C11 Reverse play as a key, time-remapping curves
- C12 Beat-quantised loop lengths inside a clip (loop roll, beat jump)
- D11 Tags, smart bins, colour labels in use, energy fader
- D12 Saved Playlists and Setlists, Lists tab
- D13 Catalog export to JSON
- E10 Soft-edge / border width on ordinary wipes
- E11 Layer mask, picture-in-picture box, split screen as a layer
- E12 Upstream/downstream keyers as separate layers (DSK)
- E13 Per-source crop, anchor point and a visible opacity fader
- F12 FFGL plug-ins, Core Image / AU passthrough
- F13 Macroblock-level motion-vector editing on MPEG-2
- G10 MIDI clock in/out, Ableton Link
- G11 Timeline / cue-list automation (record a performance, play it back)
- G13 Timecode sync (SMPTE LTC / MTC)
- G14 Sync to DJ hardware (Pro DJ Link / StageLinQ)
- H6 14-bit CC, NRPN, MIDI out (LED feedback to controllers), controller templates/fingerprinting
- H7 OSC in/out
- H8 Undo / redo (general)
- H9 Macros & AI control
- I9 Projection mapping, edge blending, multi-projector warp
- I10 Syphon / NDI / virtual camera out
- I11 Overscan as a continuous control
- J4 RTMP / SRT / NDI streaming
- J5 Recording audio with the picture
- K7 Simple mode (A/B only)
- K8 LOCK per bank

PARTIAL · 10

Built with a gap that matters on stage.

- A10 Project canvas: SD NTSC 720×480 @ 29.97 only today
- B14 Emulated titler: real Scala MM400 on Amiberry (Kickstart 3.1), out-of-process, genlock key
- B15 Native Core Text character generator
- D2 Bookmarks so moved/renamed files can be found (relink in the model)
- E9 Preview/Program (PVW/PGM) on separate buses with a take
- F14 Per-effect presets / effect snapshots
- G9 Manual BPM entry, ×2 / ÷2, downbeat ("one") finding, nudge/offset
- G12 Calibrated feedback latency (measured 3 frames / 100 ms)
- I8 Multiviewer with tally colours
- J6 Encoding off the main thread for recording/streaming

BUILT, SWITCHED OFF · 2

Off by the owner's decision, intact behind a flag.

- F10 MPEG bitstream corruptor (the wedge's damage card)
- F11 NTSC output emulation toggle on the output bar

> "It is off rather than deleted. Every node, shader, parameter and test is intact; this flag is the only thing standing between the app and all of it. Whatever it becomes next will start from the working version rather than from a rewrite."

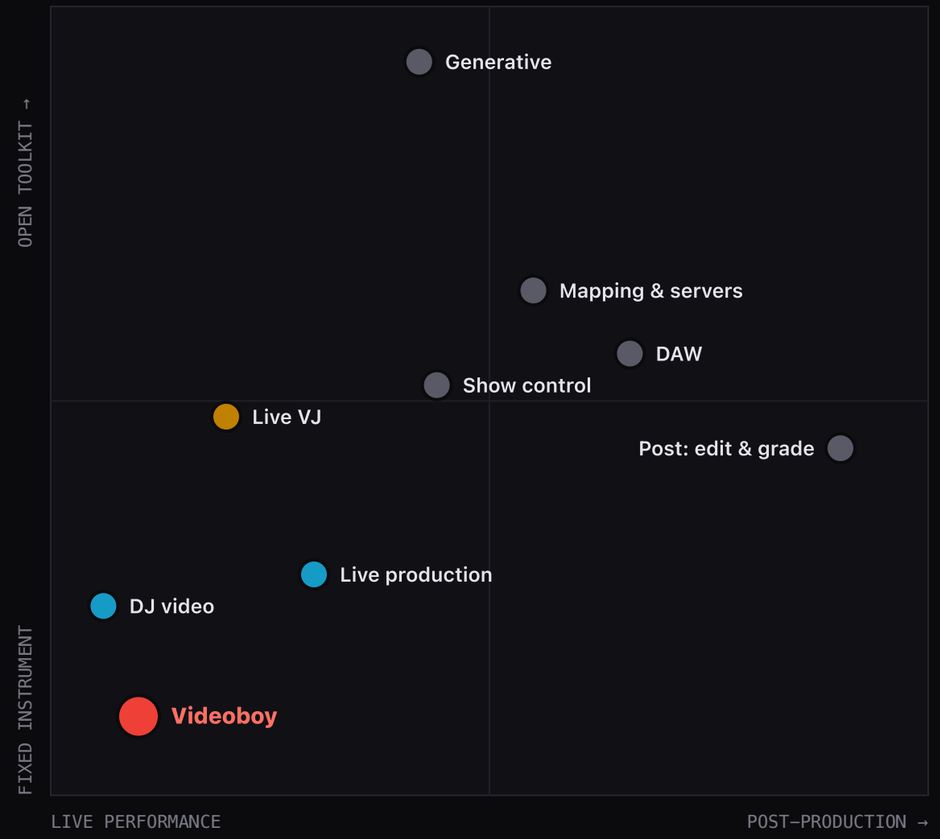
— the corruptor's flag comment, Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/VideoboyCore.swift. Switched off because it "cannot currently be JUDGED on an analog chain".

Source: feature-inventory.md · VIDEOBOY_FLAGS defaults in Core/Sources/VideoboyCore/VideoboyCore.swift

THE MARKET MAP

Eight lanes. Videoboy sits in a corner of its own.

AUTHOR'S MAP — POSITIONS ARE JUDGEMENT, NOT MEASUREMENT



LIVE VJ PERFORMANCE
Resolume · VDMX · Synesthesia · Modul8 · Magic
clip grids, layers, effects, BPM
$199–€799 once — overlap: **high**

DJ VIDEO
Serato Video · VirtualDJ · rekordbox
video tied to the track's beatgrid
~$180/yr – $499 — overlap: **medium**

LIVE PRODUCTION
vMix · ATEM · OBS · TriCaster
PGM/PVW, keyers, ISO, streaming
$60–$1,200 · hardware — overlap: **medium**

SHOW CONTROL & THEATRE
QLab · Millumin · Isadora
cue lists, GO, timecode, fades
free core – $1,399 — overlap: **low–medium**

MAPPING & MEDIA SERVERS
MadMapper · HeavyM · Watchout · disguise · Pixera
warping, blending, LED, scale
€399 – ~€3,200+ — overlap: **low**

GENERATIVE & REAL-TIME
TouchDesigner · Notch · Smode
node graphs, 3-D, interactivity
free NC – $2,200 — overlap: **low**

POST: EDIT & GRADE
Resolve · Premiere Pro · Final Cut Pro
timelines, markers, inspectors
free – $295, or $22.99/mo — overlap: **hand-off**

MUSIC: DAW
Logic Pro · Ableton Live
the musical clock, Link, controllers
$199.99 or $129/yr bundle — overlap: **clock**

VIDEOBOY'S LANE · THE ANALOG / GLITCH INSTRUMENT
Live like a VJ tool, disciplined like a switcher, timed like a DJ, aimed at an SD analog chain. No product in any lane damages a real bitstream live or models an NTSC signal path — that is the moat, and the audience is narrower than any lane's.

Lanes, positions and overlap are the author's grouping; price bands from vendor pages (appendix)

WHO'S WHO

The field on 1 October 2026.

Latest versions and list prices as published on 2026-10-01. * = secondary source; — = not published or not checked. The two right-hand columns summarise the comparison matrices.

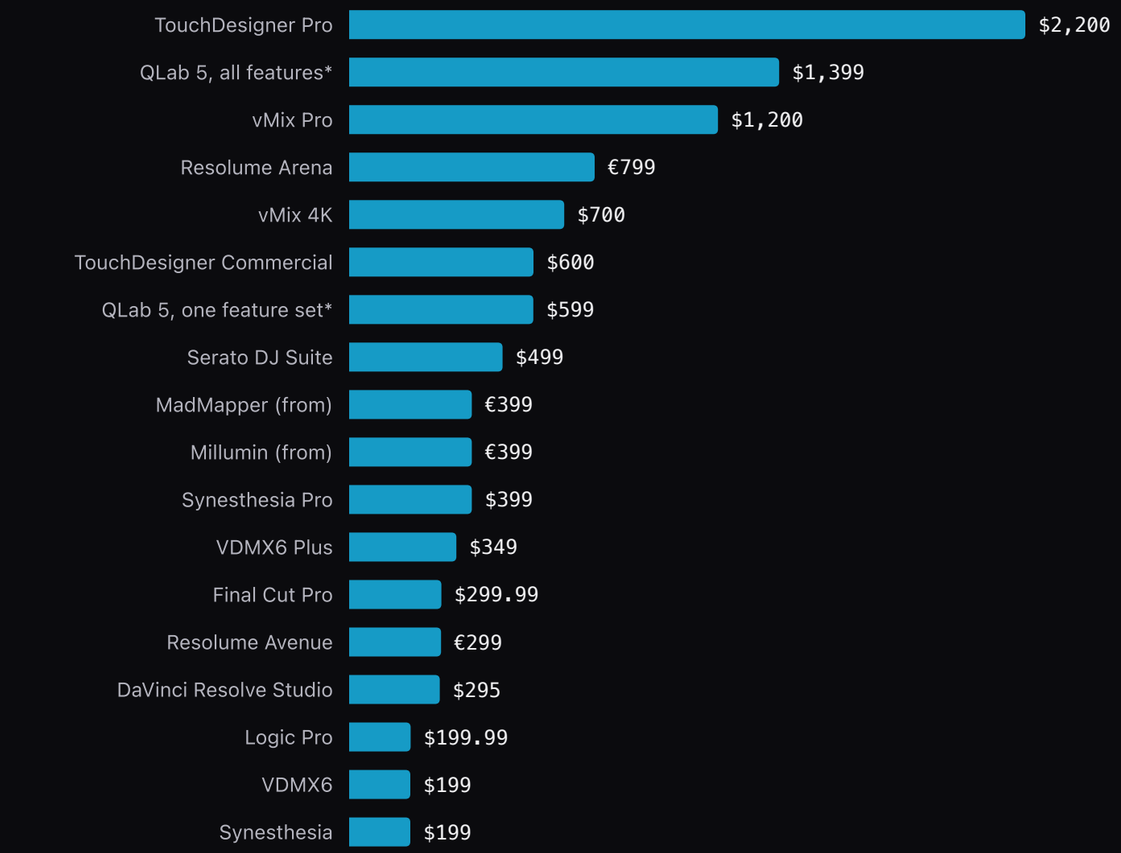
PRODUCT	LANE	PLATFORM	VERSION (2026)	PRICE	MODEL	DOES BETTER THAN VIDEOBOY	VIDEOBOY DOES BETTER
Videoboy	Analog/glitch live mixer	Mac (Apple Silicon)	0.4.10	—	private	—	—
Resolume Avenue / Arena 7	VJ · LED · mapping	Mac · Win	7.x	€299 / €799	perpetual + renewals €79 / €219	clip grid at scale, mapping, Link / SMPTE / DJ sync, OSC	bitstream looks, broadcast takes, beat detection, ISO
VDMX6 / Plus	VJ · video art	Mac	6 (1.3.8)	$199 / $349	perpetual	any data on any control, masks, vision FX, cue list	a fixed performance surface, ISO record, catalog
Millumin 5	Theatre · installation	Mac	5.14 (Jul)	€29/wk · €199/yr · from €399	rental + perpetual	timelines, cues, warping, theatre control	beat clock, live looks, ISO record
QLab 5	Theatre show control	Mac	5	free core · $599–1,399*	perpetual · rent-to-own	cue list + GO, timecode, show reliability	beat, mixing, looks
MadMapper 6	Mapping · LED · laser	Mac · Win	6.0.x	€39/mo · from €399	rental + perpetual	mapping, LED, lasers, timelines	broadcast-style mixing, ISO record
TouchDesigner	Generative · interactive	Mac · Win	–	free NC · $300 · $600 · $2,200	perpetual keys	anything you can build	ready to play in minutes
Synesthesia	Audio-reactive VJ	Mac · Win	–	$199 / $399	perpetual (+$60/yr)	100+ audio-reactive scenes	footage-first mixing, recording
Isadora 4	Theatre · interactive	Mac · Win	4	not verified	—	scene-based interactivity, Python	beat, looks
Serato Video (DJ Suite)	DJ video	Mac · Win	–	$499 or $14.99/mo	perpetual or subscription	video glued to tracks, DJ hardware	independent picture, looks, scopes
VirtualDJ 2026	DJ · karaoke video	Mac · Win	2026	$19/mo Pro	subscription (+ lifetime*)	video + karaoke + stems, any controller	looks, broadcast takes
rekordbox 7 (Creative)	DJ video	Mac · Win	7.2.8 (Apr)	~$180/yr*	subscription	phrase-aware cueing, stems, booth standard	picture-first mixing
vMix	Live production	Win	–	$60–1,200 · $50/mo	perpetual + subscription	overlays, titles, replay, streaming	the beat, the looks, macOS
DaVinci Resolve 21	Post · grading	Mac · Win · Linux	21 (Apr beta)	free · $295	free + perpetual	edit, grade and audio, free tier	live
Premiere Pro 26.5	Post · editing	Mac · Win	26.5 (Sep)	$22.99/mo	subscription	editing ecosystem, AI tools	live
Logic Pro 12 · Final Cut Pro	DAW · editing	Mac · iPad	12.3.1	$199.99 · $299.99 · $129/yr bundle	perpetual + Creator Studio	musical timeline, Apple bundle	live picture
Watchout · disguise · Pixera · Smode · Notch	Media servers · real-time	mostly Win	–	~€3,200 · $159/mo · free tiers*	mixed	scale, multi-projector shows	price, intimacy, the analog look

Sources: vendor shops and release notes (appendix) · QLab tiers via Capterra* · rekordbox via dj.studio* · media-server prices via secondary sites*

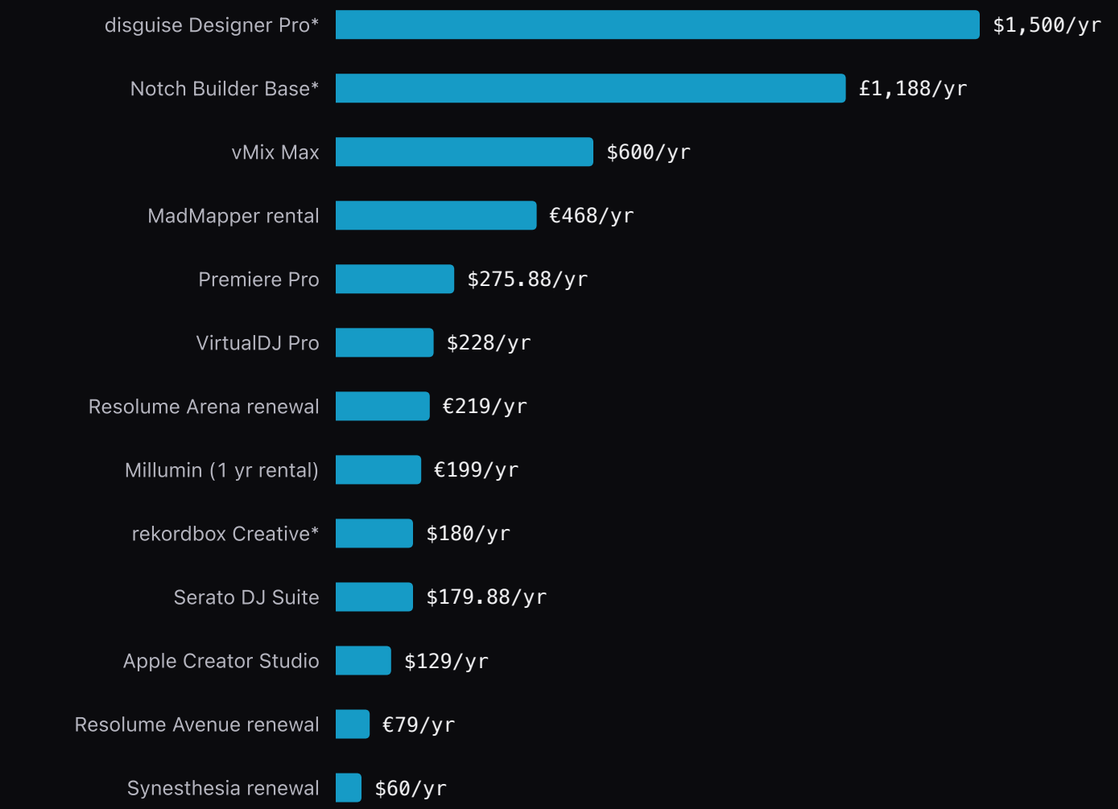
PRICING LANDSCAPE

Live video still sells licences. DJ and editing software increasingly rent.

BUY ONCE — LIST PRICE OF EACH LICENCE TIER (SELECTED)



PAY YEARLY — SUBSCRIPTIONS, RENTALS AND UPDATE RENEWALS



Not shown: Watchout 7 at ~€3,200 a licence*; free tiers (Resolve, TouchDesigner non-commercial, QLab core, disguise Starter, Pixera Creator, Smode Community). Currencies are not converted; € and £ amounts would read ~10–25% higher in dollars.

Sources: resolume.com/shop · vidvox.net · millumin.com/v5 · madmapper · derivative.ca · synesthesia.live · serato.com · virtualdj.com · vmix.com · Apple · Adobe · * secondary

BUSINESS MODELS

Six ways to charge. VJ tools agree on one: pay once.

RESOLUME, SYNESTHESIA, VMIX

Perpetual + paid update year

Own the version forever; renew to keep getting updates (Resolume €79 / €219, Synesthesia $60, vMix $60*).

VDMX, MADMAPPER, MILLUMIN, MODUL8, FINAL CUT PRO, LOGIC PRO

Perpetual, paid upgrades

Buy a major version; pay to upgrade at the next one (Millumin V5 upgrade from €85).

MILLUMIN, QLAB, MADMAPPER, NOTCH

Rental beside perpetual

Short rentals for shows and tours: Millumin €29/week, QLab $8–15/day*, MadMapper €39/month.

REKORDBOX, PREMIERE PRO, VIRTUALDJ, DISGUISE PRO*

Subscription-led

rekordbox ~$180/yr*, Premiere $22.99/mo, VirtualDJ $19/mo (a lifetime licence is also reported*).

APPLE CREATOR STUDIO, SERATO DJ SUITE

Bundle subscription

Apple: Final Cut, Logic, Pixelmator Pro, Motion, Compressor, MainStage for $129/yr; Serato Suite $14.99/mo or $499.

DAVINCI RESOLVE, TOUCHDESIGNER, QLAB, PIXERA, SMODE

Free tier + paid pro

Free with limits (resolution, watermark, features); Resolve Studio $295 once; TouchDesigner $600–2,200.

PRODUCT	TRIAL, DEMO AND DISCOUNT TERMS	SOURCE
Resolume	fully functional demo with a watermark; Avenue → Arena by paying the difference; education 50%; 1–60 machines per licence	resolume.com
Millumin 5	30-day trial with every feature, then watermarked output; education pricing; extra seats from the account page	millumin.com/v5
MadMapper	free version with every feature: watermarked video, DMX blackout every 30 s, scanner at ¼ resolution	madmapper (CDM / store)
Synesthesia	unlimited trial, watermarked; Standard on 1 device, Pro on 2; renewals $60/yr (currently free)	synesthesia.live/pricing
TouchDesigner	Non-Commercial free: 1280×1280, not for paid work, 10 keys per account	derivative.ca
QLab 5	free tier with audio, video and lighting cues; rent-to-own after 110 days*; site licence $299 per activation (10+)*	qlab.app · Capterra*
VDMX6	educational, hobbyist and upgrade discounts	vidvox.net

WHAT THE MARKET ACCEPTS

VJs pay once, in a $199–$399 / €299–€799 band, with a year of updates and an optional renewal.

Touring shows rent per machine for a week or a month — that is how a $1,399 tool reaches a one-night user.

Everyone expects a free, watermarked way to try it first.

2026: Apple priced six pro apps at $129 a year; a specialist tool now has to justify itself on what nobody else does.

Sources: vendor price and licence pages (appendix) · TidBITS / MacRumors on Apple Creator Studio (Jan 2026) · * secondary

SIGNALS FROM 2026

What moved this year, and what it means here.

AI is now a control surface

Resolume documents an MCP server for AI control; MadMapper's Mad AI writes materials from a prompt; Magic 2.5 added AI prompting.

RESOLUME.COM/SUPPORT · MADMAPPER DOCS

FOR VIDEOBOY

Param codes are already stable addresses: an OSC / MCP surface over them is a small step, and Settings ▸ Macros & AI is waiting.

Editors went AI-first

Premiere 26 (Jan) added AI search, Generative Extend and Object Mask; 26.5 (Sep) a Generative Media Tool. Resolve 21 (Apr) added IntelliSearch and a Photo page.

ADOBE · BLACKMAGIC

FOR VIDEOBOY

Hand off to editors rather than compete: a cut list makes every ISO take searchable and re-cuttable there.

DJ prep is automated

rekordbox 7's CUE Analysis places hot and memory cues by phrase and learns a DJ's style; 4-stem separation since 7.2.8 (Apr 2026).

REKORDBOX.COM · DIGITAL DJ TIPS

FOR VIDEOBOY

The video twin of phrase analysis is shot-change detection: auto-placed hot cues.

DJ gear talks to visuals

StageLinQ drives Resolume and SoundSwitch; AlphaTheta added SoundSwitch to rekordbox and PRO DJ LINK Bridge in Sep 2026.

DJWORX · EDMTUNES

FOR VIDEOBOY

Song linking via Apple Music is the light path; Pro DJ Link / StageLinQ for track data can follow.

Theatre tools learned timelines

Millumin 5 (Apr 2026) added multi-canvas timelines and Bezier keyframes; MadMapper 6's timelines replaced its cues.

MILLUMIN.COM · CDM

FOR VIDEOBOY

Setlists plus a rundown view are the right size; don't build a keyframe timeline.

TouchDesigner became a platform

VDMX6 and Millumin 5 both run TouchDesigner components inside them (commercial TD licence required).

VIDVOX.NET · MILLUMIN.COM

FOR VIDEOBOY

Syphon in and out lets TouchDesigner feed Videoboy and the reverse, without hosting it.

Apple bundled its pro apps

Creator Studio, 28 Jan 2026: Final Cut, Logic and four more for $129 a year; one-time licences still sold.

TIDBITS · MACRUMORS

FOR VIDEOBOY

Price against the specialist band ($199–$399), never against a $129 bundle.

Dependencies kill tools

CoGe VJ is gone: it was built on Quartz Composer and runs on nothing newer than Mojave.

IMIMOT.COM

FOR VIDEOBOY

Stay Metal-native, LGPL-only, GPL out of process. Avoid deprecated frameworks.

Sources: listed on each card; full URLs in the appendix · "For Videoboy" lines are the author's view

FEATURE MATRIX · LIVE TOOLS (1/2)

Against the seven live tools people switch from.

● offered ◐ partial / indirect — not offered, or not found in the docs reviewed ? not verified n/a not applicable

FEATURE	VIDEOBOY 0.4.10	RESOLUME ARENA 7	VDMX6 PLUS	MILLUMIN 5	QLAB 5 + VIDEO	MADMAPPER 6	TOUCHDESIGNER	SYNESTHESIA PRO	NOTE
PRICE	not on sale	€799	$349	from €399	$599–1,399*	from €399	$600	$399	
PLATFORM	Mac (Apple Silicon)	Mac · Win	Mac	Mac	Mac	Mac · Win	Mac · Win	Mac · Win	
SOURCES & MEDIA									
Video files, common codecs	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	all eight
GPU performance codec (HAP or DXV)	—	●	●	●	●	●	●	?	VB optimizes to MPEG-2 GOP 6 for the wedge; Resolume = DXV; hap.video list
Cameras and capture cards	●	●	●	?	●	●	●	●	QLab camera cues; Synesthesia webcams
Screen / window capture	●	?	●	●	?	?	●	?	VB: ScreenCaptureKit window capture
NDI in / out	—	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	Synesthesia: Pro tier
Syphon in / out	—	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	VB: optional backlog item
Built-in generators / scenes	●	●	●	◐	—	●	●	●	VB: 13 native + ISF; Millumin: gradients, text, shader transitions
ISF shader import	●	●	●	?	?	●	?	●	Resolume: Wire + 7.8; MadMapper materials are ISF-based
Text and titles as a live source	◐	●	●	●	●	●	●	?	VB: Now Playing + Scala titler; Core Text CG built but not reachable
PLAYBACK & CUEING									
Loop · ping-pong · play once	●	●	●	?	◐	?	●	?	QLab: loops + hold at end
Cue points / hot cues inside a clip	—	●	?	◐	◐	◐	◐	?	Millumin cues recall a time; QLab start/end per cue; MadMapper markers
Beat-synced clip playback	●	●	●	—	—	●	●	●	VB: STEP ladder, BEAT, quantised pads; Millumin has no BPM follow
Speed control and reverse	◐	●	●	?	◐	?	●	?	VB: speed; reverse only inside ping-pong
Clip launcher (grid / pads)	●	●	●	●	◐	●	◐	●	VB: 8 Clip Pads + library double-click; TD: build it yourself
Queue / autopilot (what plays next)	●	●	?	●	●	●	◐	?	VB: Queue, Play Next, ADV, ROLL; Resolume Auto Pilot
Cue list or timeline with GO	—	—	●	●	●	●	◐	?	VDMX Cue List plugin; MadMapper 6 timelines; VB Setlists planned
Keyframes / envelopes	◐	●	◐	●	●	●	●	?	VB: LFOs + beat sweeps; QLab fade cues
MIXING & COMPOSITING									
Crossfader / A–B mix	●	●	●	?	◐	?	●	?	VB: three faders (A↔B, C↔D, ONE↔TWO)
Transition library	●	●	●	●	◐	?	●	?	VB: 13 patterns incl. AVE-5; QLab: fades
Blend modes	●	●	●	●	●	?	●	?	VB 13 + Key; VDMX 20+ blend modes and transitions
Masks and keys	◐	●	●	●	●	●	●	?	VB: Key blend only; Layer Mask in backlog
Per-layer geometry: position, scale, rotate, crop	◐	●	●	●	●	●	●	?	VB Transform: scale/position/rotation/flip — no crop or anchor
Unlimited layers	—	●	●	●	●	●	●	◐	VB: 4 sources → 2 buses → Program, fixed by design

Sources: vendor documentation per product (appendix) · Videoboy cells re-checked against feature-inventory.md (45 cells, 0 disagreements)

FEATURE MATRIX · LIVE TOOLS (2/2)

Looks, time, control, output and the library.

● offered ◐ partial / indirect – not offered, or not found in the docs reviewed ? not verified n/a not applicable

FEATURE	VIDEOBOY 0.4.10	RESOLUME ARENA 7	VDMX6 PLUS	MILLUMIN 5	QLAB 5 + VIDEO	MADMAPPER 6	TOUCHDESIGNER	SYNESTHESIA PRO	NOTE
LOOK									
Live datamosh on a real H.264 bitstream	●	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	look-alike shaders exist; none damage a live bitstream
NTSC composite signal model	●	?	◐	–	–	?	◐	?	VDMX: behavioural VHS-style ISF filters; TD: buildable
Vision / AI features (tracking, background removal)	–	?	●	◐	?	◐	●	?	VDMX tracking + background removal; Mad AI materials; Millumin Kinect/Leap
TIME & SYNC									
Tap tempo	●	●	●	–	–	●	●	?	Millumin and QLab have no tempo concept
Automatic beat detection from audio	●	–	●	–	–	●	◐	◐	VB: BeatNet from any app's audio; Resolume: tap / Link / DJ sync
Ableton Link	–	●	●	–	–	●	●	?	VB: removed from CLOCK as unbuilt
MIDI clock in	–	●	●	–	–	●	●	?	VDMX: Clock plugin (MIDI Follow)
Timecode (SMPTE / LTC / MTC)	–	●	●	●	●	●	●	?	Resolume: SMPTE in, Arena only
DJ hardware sync (Pro DJ Link / StageLinQ)	–	●	?	–	–	?	◐	?	Resolume Arena; VB plans Apple Music song links instead
CONTROL									
MIDI learn	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	VB: Shift-click any control
OSC in / out	–	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	VB status bar reads "OSC: off"
Scripting or API	–	●	?	●	●	?	●	◐	Resolume REST/WebSocket/MCP; Millumin JavaScript; TD Python
Undo / redo	–	●	◐	●	?	?	●	?	VB: targeted take-backs only; VDMX limited
OUTPUT & RECORD									
Multiple outputs / displays	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	?	VB: send to any display, four-up
Mapping, warping, edge blending	–	●	◐	●	●	●	●	?	VB: out of scope by design; VDMX perspective correction
Record the output (built in)	●	●	●	◐	?	◐	●	–	Millumin: Syphon Recorder or timeline export; Synesthesia: third-party only
Program + every input recorded in one take (ISO)	●	?	?	–	?	–	◐	–	VB: ProRes / H.264 / HEVC, one folder per take
Video scopes	●	–	●	?	?	?	◐	?	VB: WFM/RGB/HIST/VEC + NTSC legality; Resolume: third-party FFGL
SD / analog-first output tools (480i, safe, overscan, BFI, bars)	●	?	?	?	?	◐	◐	–	MadMapper: calibration generators
LIBRARY & SHOW									
Media catalog with import (add / move / copy, duplicates, bins)	●	◐	◐	◐	–	◐	–	◐	VB: Lightroom-model catalog; Resolume Media Manager; Millumin Synced Library
Linked optimized media (transcode on import)	●	◐	◐	?	–	?	–	–	Resolume: Alley converter; VDMX: separate HAP converter
Presets / snapshots	◐	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	VB: whole-show files + pads; Setlists planned

Sources: vendor documentation per product (appendix) · Videoboy cells re-checked against feature-inventory.md (45 cells, 0 disagreements)

FEATURE MATRIX · ADJACENT TOOLS

Where the DJs, the switchers and the editors already are.

● offered ◐ partial / indirect — not offered, or not found in the docs reviewed ? not verified n/a not applicable

CAPABILITY	VIDEOBOY	SERATO VIDEO	VIRTUALDJ PRO	VMIX 4K / PRO	ATEM MINI ISO	RESOLVE 21	PREMIERE 26.5	LOGIC PRO 12	NOTE
PRICE	—	$499 or $14.99/mo (Suite)	$19/mo	$350–1,200 or $50/mo	hardware	free · $295	$22.99/mo (annual)	$199.99 or $129/yr	
Live switching of video sources	●	●	●	●	●	—	—	—	
Picture follows the music clock	●	●	●	—	—	—	—	—	DJ apps tie video to the track's beatgrid
Automatic tempo detection	●	●	●	—	—	?	?	●	Logic: Smart Tempo
Cue points / markers in media	—	●	●	◐	—	●	●	●	vMix: replay marks
Transitions and wipes	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	—	vMix: 13 + up to 8 stingers
Overlay / downstream key layer	◐	◐	●	●	●	●	●	—	ATEM: USK + DSK; vMix: 8 overlay channels
Titles / character generator	◐	●	●	●	◐	●	●	—	vMix: 100+ templates
Program + every input recorded (ISO)	●	◐	◐	●	●	n/a	n/a	n/a	DJ apps record the mix
Live cut exported as an editable timeline	—	—	—	?	●	n/a	n/a	n/a	ATEM ISO writes a Resolve project
Video scopes	●	—	—	●	?	●	●	—	
Streaming out	◐	?	?	●	●	—	—	—	VB: MPEG-TS over UDP to OBS
Plays audio	—	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	VB is silent by design (SPEC §21)
AI features shipped in 2026	◐	●	●	?	—	●	●	●	VB: neural beat tracking; others: stems, AI search, generative

Against DJ video

Serato, VirtualDJ and rekordbox own the beat and the cue points, and their video follows the track. Videoboy's picture follows the room's beat instead, from any audio, and its looks and broadcast discipline go far deeper. It cannot mark points inside a clip.

Against live production

vMix and ATEM own switching, overlays, ISO recording and streaming; ATEM ISO even writes an editable Resolve project of the show. Videoboy matches the switching and the ISO recording, adds the beat, and lacks the overlay layer and the edit export.

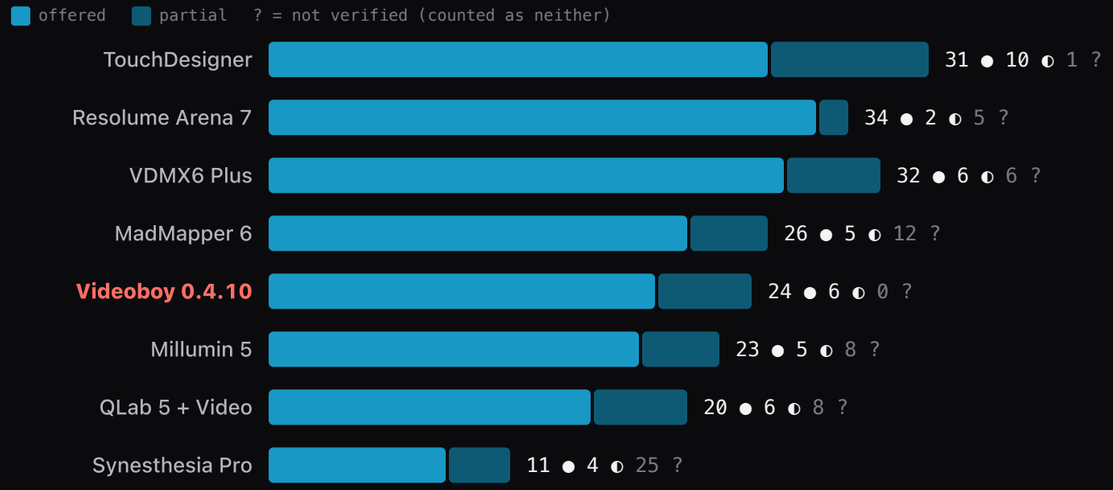
Against post and the DAW

Resolve, Premiere and Logic are where a live performance ends up and where performers learned their habits: markers, inspectors, undo, key commands. Videoboy should export into them, not imitate them.

Sources: serato.com · virtualdj.com · vmix.com · blackmagicdesign.com · adobe.com · apple.com (appendix)

SCOREBOARD

Breadth goes to the open tools. Depth in one lane goes to Videoboy.



ROWS ONLY VIDEOBOY FILLS

- Live datamosh on a real H.264 bitstream
- NTSC composite signal model
- Program + every input recorded in one take (ISO)
- SD / analog-first output tools (480i, safe, overscan, BFI, bars)
- Media catalog with import (add / move / copy, duplicates, bins)
- Linked optimized media (transcode on import)

TouchDesigner, Resolume and VDMX lead on breadth. MadMapper would likely join them — 12 of its cells are unverified — and Synesthesia's short bar mostly reflects 25 unverified cells, not missing features. Videoboy's count is lower because it is a fixed-format instrument; it is the only product with a full mark in every row that defines its lane.

OFFERED (+ PARTIAL) BY CATEGORY	SOURCES & MEDIA 9	PLAYBACK & CUEING 8	MIXING & COMPOSITING 6	LOOK 3	TIME & SYNC 6	CONTROL 4	OUTPUT & RECORD 6	LIBRARY & SHOW 3
TouchDesigner	8	4+4	6	1+1	4+2	4	3+3	1
Resolume Arena 7	8	7	6	0	5	4	3	1+2
VDMX6 Plus	9	5+1	6	1+1	5	2+1	3+1	1+2
MadMapper 6	8	5+1	3	0+1	5	2	2+2	1+1
Videoboy 0.4.10	5+1	4+2	3+2	2	2	1	5	2+1
Millumin 5	6+1	4+1	5	0+1	1	4	2+1	1+1
QLab 5 + Video	6	3+4	4+2	0	1	3	2	1
Synesthesia Pro	6	2	0+1	0	0+1	2+1	0	1+1

Computed by build_deck.py from deck_data.py LIVE_ROWS (45 rows); unverified cells excluded; shading = share offered

INSPECTORS COMPARED

Their inspectors are where their features live.

Resolume · clip / layer

- Timeline · BPM Sync · SMPTE · Denon
- Loop, Ping Pong, Random, Play Once and Eject / Hold
- cue points · Beat Looper · Beat Snap
- trigger Normal / Toggle / Piano · Fader Start
- Auto Pilot after N loops · per-clip transition
- layer: mask mode, lock, solo, bypass, transition 0–10 s

VDMX6 · layer

- source: movie rate, range, loop; NDI, Syphon, ISF, TD
- FX chain: CI, ISF, FFGL, shape/chroma/layer masks
- vision: background removal, face/body/hand tracking
- composition: 20+ blends, crop, rect or quad map
- any control ← any data source (LFO, audio, clock)
- plugins: Cue List, Scopes, step sequencer

QLab 5 · video cue

- Basics, Triggers (hotkey, MIDI, timecode, clock)
- Geometry: fit / fill / stretch, or
- crop, translation, scale, 3-D rotation, anchor
- Time & Loops: start/end, loops, hold at end
- Video FX: blend mode + live effect stack
- fade cues for any of it; GO

Millumin 5 · layer

- media: video, NDI, Syphon, screen, web, text, TOX
- mesh warp, masks at every level, soft edge
- groups with blend / opacity / effects
- custom and shader transitions
- Bezier keyframes on timelines; cues recall a time
- JavaScript; controls ATEM, PJ-Link, PTZ

MadMapper 6 · surface

- quads, circles, masks, unlimited-point mesh warp
- soft-edge blending
- ISF-based Materials (+ Mad AI)
- timelines: keyframes, markers, FFT audio track
- MIDI / OSC output tracks · beat tracking
- Link, MIDI clock, Syphon, NDI

INSPECTOR CATEGORY (FROM THE MATRIX ROWS)	VIDEOBOY	RESOLUME	VDMX6	QLAB 5	MILLUMIN 5	MADMAPPER 6
Media and source settings	●	●	●	●	●	●
Loops and play modes	●	●	●	◐	?	?
Cue points inside media	–	●	?	◐	◐	◐
Geometry: position, scale, crop	◐	●	●	●	●	●
Masks and keys	◐	●	●	●	●	●
Blend modes	●	●	●	●	●	?
Keyframes / envelopes	◐	●	◐	●	●	●
Beat-synced playback	●	●	●	–	–	●
Timecode	–	●	●	●	●	●

VIDEOBOY · NO SINGLE INSPECTOR

Properties live where they act

Source Controls (speed, scrub, generator parameters) tops each FX panel; every **card** shows each parameter on two lines with its code and MIDI · AUD · LFO badges; transitions and blends open from their keys. Closer to a hardware mixer than to QLab or Resolve — and right for hands.

The missing half is geometry and compositing: crop, anchor, opacity and masks in one place, most with keyframes. Videoboy's Transform card has scale, position, rotation and flip; layer opacity (66A) has no fader.

Sources: resolume.com/support (clips, video, layers) · vdmx.vidvox.net · qlab.app/docs/v5/video · millumin.com/v5 · docs.madmapper.com

MAJOR GAPS

Twelve things a VJ, a theatre designer or a video artist would miss.

● essential · ◐ useful · ○ rarely needed — for VJs, theatre video designers and video artists, in that order. Size: S ≈ a day, M ≈ a few days, L ≈ a week or more (author's estimate). DMX left out, as asked.

#	MISSING FROM VIDEOBOY	WHO HAS IT	VJ · THEATRE · ARTIST	SIZE	NOTE
M1	**Cue points / hot cues inside a clip**	Resolume, QLab, Millumin, MadMapper, all DJ apps	● ● ●	M	deep dive §5.1
M2	**Cue list or timeline with GO (numbered cues, timed fades, auto-follow)**	QLab, Millumin, MadMapper, Isadora, VDMX	○ ● ◐	L	Setlists cover part
M3	**Masks (shape, chroma, layer)**	VDMX, Resolume, Millumin, MadMapper, QLab	● ● ●	M	Layer Mask in backlog
M4	**Syphon and NDI, in and out**	every live competitor	● ● ●	S–M	Syphon out is the cheapest step
M5	**OSC in / out**	every live competitor	● ● ●	S–M	ControlEvent bus was designed for it
M6	**MIDI clock + Ableton Link**	Resolume, VDMX, MadMapper, TouchDesigner, DJ apps	● ○ ◐	M	removed from CLOCK as unbuilt
M7	**Timecode (SMPTE LTC / MTC)**	Resolume Arena, VDMX, MadMapper, Millumin, Isadora, QLab	○ ● ◐	M	theatre and broadcast run on a clock
M8	**Undo / redo**	Resolume, Millumin, TouchDesigner, every editor	● ● ●	M–L	owner: "a consistent bug"
M9	**Per-source geometry: crop, anchor, opacity fader, keyframes**	QLab, VDMX, Resolume, Millumin	◐ ● ●	M	Transform has scale/position/rotate/flip
M10	**Text and titles as an editable source**	Resolume, VDMX, Millumin, QLab, MadMapper	◐ ● ◐	M	Core Text CG built, not reachable
M11	**Presets and snapshots for effects, transitions, layers**	Resolume, VDMX, MadMapper, Millumin	● ● ●	M	Setlists / E-MEM idea
M12	**A performance codec with alpha (HAP / DXV)**	VDMX, Resolume, Millumin, MadMapper, QLab	● ◐ ●	M	MPEG-2 stays right for the wedge

BUILD FIRST
Syphon out + OSC
cheap; joins every rig

THEN
Hot cues
the biggest performance gap

THEN
Undo
the owner already called it a bug

THEN
Presets / snapshots
as Setlists and E-MEMs

THEN
MIDI clock + Link
follow the booth

Source: docs/research/2026-10-01/03-competitors-and-gaps.md §3.1 · sizes are the author's estimates

MINOR GAPS — AND WHERE VIDEOBOY LEADS

Fifteen nice-to-haves. Ten things nobody else does.

#	MISSING, MINOR	WHO HAS IT
m1	Pad trigger styles: momentary and toggle	Resolume
m2	Random / shuffle play; autopilot after N loops	Resolume (beat shuffle planned 0.5.0)
m3	Reverse key and scratch	Resolume, DJ apps
m4	Envelopes / keyframed parameter curves	Resolume, Millumin, MadMapper
m5	More blend modes	VDMX (20+), Resolume
m6	LUTs	Resolume
m7	Notes panel, remaining-time clock	Resolume
m8	Scripting / API (JS, Python, REST, MCP)	Millumin, Isadora, TouchDesigner, Resolume
m9	Vision: background removal, tracking, object masks	VDMX, Premiere
m10	Web / HTML / slide sources	Millumin, vMix
m11	Projector / ATEM / Stream Deck control	Millumin, Isadora
m12	10-bit / HDR output	Resolume, Millumin
m13	Mapping: warping, edge blending, slices	Arena, MadMapper, Millumin, QLab — out of scope
m14	Audio playback with the picture	QLab, Millumin, Resolume — excluded (SPEC §21)
m15	3-D, particles, generative scenes	TouchDesigner, Notch, Smode — not this product

VIDEOBOY IS AHEAD	NEAREST COMPETITOR
Live datamosh on a real H.264 bitstream (MOSH / HEAL / bloom, beat-timed)	none live
NTSC composite signal model (dot crawl, chroma bleed, TBC wobble)	shader approximations
AVE-5 wipe block emulated from the operating manual (31 patterns)	none
Real vintage titler (Scala MM400 on Amiberry) as a live source	none
Neural beat detection (BeatNet) from any app's audio	VDMX detects BPM; Resolume taps
Program + A/B/C/D recorded in one take	ATEM ISO hardware
Lightroom-model import and catalog with linked optimized media	no Add / Move / Copy importer in VJ tools
Broadcast idioms: Hot Punch, A/B ROLL, ADV, bus keys, tally	vMix / ATEM, not VJ apps
NTSC-legal scopes: WFM, RGB, HIST, VEC, IRE legality	Resolve, vMix, VDMX Scopes
Stable param codes and hand-editable plain-text shows	project files not designed for hand edits

Source: 03-competitors-and-gaps.md §3.2–3.3 · competitor documentation (appendix)

FIVE WINDOWS COMPARED

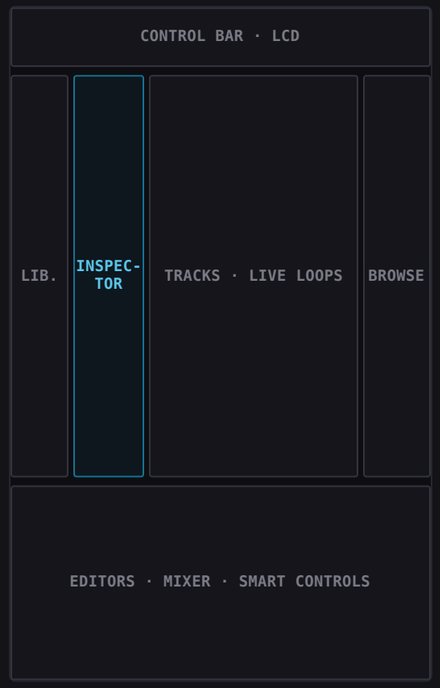
Five apps, five ideas about where things go.

Videoboy 0.4.10



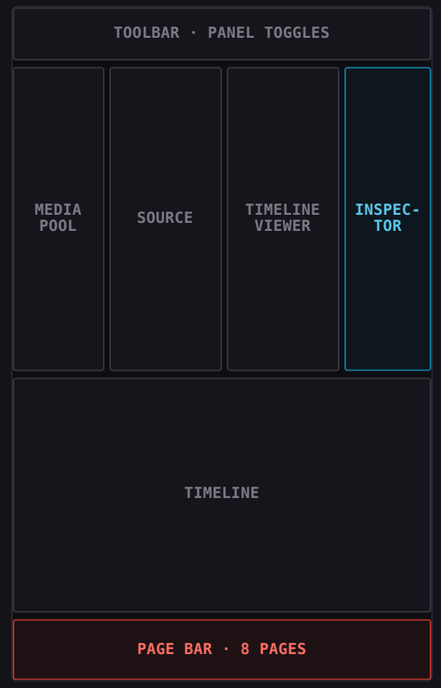
Fixed 5×5 grid that collapses but never moves. Seven live monitors. Properties sit on the cards and keys.

Logic Pro 12



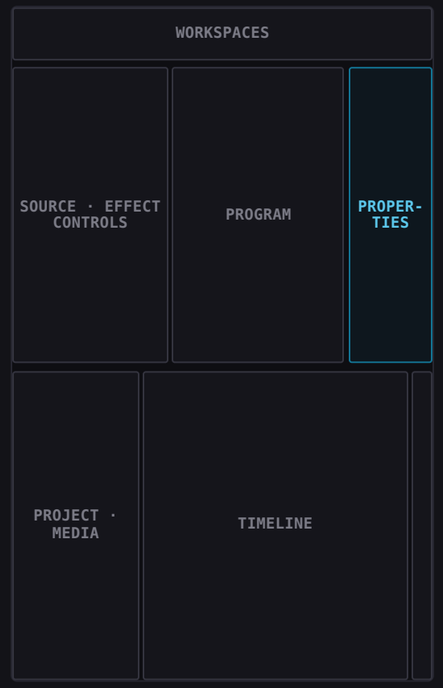
One window with areas shown or hidden; Inspector at left; tracks or a Live Loops grid in the centre.

DaVinci Resolve 21



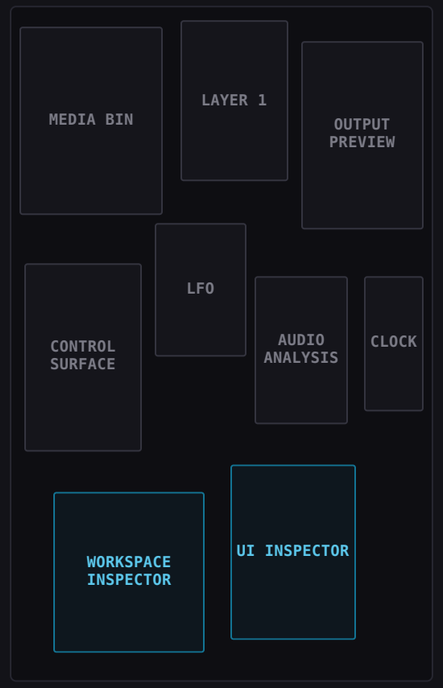
Fixed page layouts behind a page bar — the model Videoboy's mode bar copied. Inspector at right.

Premiere Pro 26



Dockable panels saved as workspaces; Source and Program monitors; the new Properties panel.

VDMX6



Floating plugin windows the user arranges; two inspector windows; any control takes any data source.

■ where properties are edited ■ mode / page / program Schematic wireframes drawn for this report from each product's documented layout, not screenshots.

INTERFACE PARADIGMS

A fixed window, like Resolve and Logic — not Premiere's docks or VDMX's floats.

The fixed grid is a performance decision: a performer's hands are on the controls, so nothing may move. It is the deliberate break from VDMX, and the reason Videoboy can't simply add panels.

	VIDEOBOY	LOGIC PRO 12	RESOLVE 21	PREMIERE PRO 26	VDMX6
LAYOUT MODEL	fixed 5×5 grid; panels collapse, never move	one window; areas shown/hidden	fixed page layouts; panels toggled	dockable panels, saved workspaces	free-floating plugin windows, user layouts
MODES / PAGES	IMPORT · VJ · SETTINGS (⌘1–3)	Tracks ↔ Live Loops views	Media · Cut · Edit · Fusion · Color · Fairlight · Deliver · Photo	workspaces (Editing, Color, Audio, Graphics…)	workspaces; no modes
TIME MODEL	live, beat-clocked (BPM · DIV · BEAT)	timeline + quantised cell grid	timecode timeline	timecode timeline	live; Clock plugin + Cue List
WHERE PROPERTIES LIVE	on the surface: cards, Source Controls, keys	Inspector (region, track, channel strips)	Inspector panel (tabs)	Effect Controls + Properties panel	Workspace + UI Inspector windows
MEDIA	Asset Browser + 2 libraries + Import mode catalog	browsers (files, loops) + Library	Media Pool, bins, smart bins	Project panel + Media Browser	Media Bin with pages
MONITORS	7: four sources, two sub-mixes, Program	movie window	source + timeline viewers	Source + Program monitors	preview windows per layer
TRANSPORT	central glass cluster: BPM, CLOCK, DIV, FMT, record	control-bar LCD	viewer transport	monitor transport	Clock plugin
HARDWARE LEARN	Shift-click any control; MIDI · AUD · LFO badges	Controller Assignments (learn)	dedicated panels (Speed Editor…)	shortcuts; third-party surfaces	detect on any control; any data source
UNDO	targeted take-backs	full history	full history	History panel	limited
CUSTOMISATION	none by design (collapse only)	moderate	low	high	total

Sources: as previous page · Videoboy CLAUDE.md "Layout is fixed" · SPEC §14

WHAT TO TAKE FROM EACH

Steal the ideas, keep the grid.

LOGIC PRO

Borrow next

Key Commands editor; Smart Controls (one knob → many params); Live Loops scenes; Logic Remote on iPad; full undo history

ALREADY BORROWED

density and the LCD transport cluster

DAVINCI RESOLVE

Borrow next

a tabbed Inspector drawer per source (geometry, crop, opacity); smart bins and keywords; dedicated control hardware

ALREADY BORROWED

the page bar (⌘1–3) and linked optimized media

PREMIERE PRO

Borrow next

the contextual Properties panel; Essential Graphics-style title templates with live data; a visual shortcut editor

ALREADY BORROWED

two-monitor source/program thinking

VDMX

Borrow next

any data source on any control (OSC, clock, step sequencer); Cue List; Scopes plugin; Syphon / NDI

ALREADY BORROWED

Shift-detect, ISF, VDMX-style echo

A geometry drawer, not an inspector window

Resolve-style tabs (Transform · Crop · Composite) that slide out of a source panel's title bar on demand — the M9 gap closed without breaking the fixed grid.

Smart Controls for a whole bank

Logic maps one knob to many parameters. A bank macro (one fader sweeps mosh, feedback zoom and hue together) is the cheapest performance preset there is, and Settings ▸ Macros & AI already exists.

Profiles instead of workspaces

Premiere lets every user rebuild the room. Videoboy can't, so it should offer states: a DJ profile (pads in cue mode), a broadcast profile (Program/Preview on the 1/2 row), a theatre profile (rundown).

INTERFACE SCORECARD — THE AUTHOR'S RATINGS, 1–5 (OPINION)

QUALITY	VIDEOBOY	LOGIC PRO 12	RESOLVE 21	PREMIERE PRO 26	VDMX6	WHY, FOR VIDEOBOY
Readable on stage	●●●●●	●●●○○	●●●○○	●●○○○	●●○○○	fixed grid, big faders, tally, nothing moves
Information density	●●●●●	●●●●○	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●●●○	seven monitors and every control in one window
Learnability, first hour	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●○○○	dense, custom keys, no manual yet
Safety: undo and lock	●●○○○	●●●●●	●●●●●	●●●●●	●●○○○	take-backs only; LOCK planned
Hardware integration	●●●○○	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●●○○	●●●●●	learn on everything; no MIDI out or templates
Keyboard depth	●●○○○	●●●●●	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●●○○	hot keys pane and pad numbers only
Customisation	●○○○○	●●●○○	●●○○○	●●●●●	●●●●●	none, by design

Sources: as previous pages · Videoboy docs/DESIGN-BACKLOG.md, docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-26.md (already borrowed) · ratings are the author's

DEEP DIVE · TWO WORLDS

A DJ's clock and a switcher's routing. Missing: memory.

	DJS HAVE	BROADCAST HAS	VIDEOBOY HAS
INSIDE A CLIP	8 hot cues, memory cues, loops, beat jump, slip	cue points marked on the fly (EVS)	one in/out pair
BEFORE IT AIRS	CUE / PFL in the headphones	Preview bus + multiviewer	sub-mix monitors
TAKING IT	crossfader + curve, quantise	CUT / AUTO / T-bar, RATE per style, stingers	CUT / FADE / 13 patterns, beat-quantised ●
ON TOP	—	keyers + downstream keyers with own CUT / AUTO	Key blend on a fader
REMEMBERING A LOOK	—	E-MEM: learn the whole state, recall in one press	show files; Setlists planned
RUNNING ORDER	playlists, history, smart crates	rundown (reader · VO · SOT · PKG), back-timing, MOS	Queue (new); Setlists planned
AFTER THE SHOW	recording of the mix	ISO recordings + a project of every cut	ISO recordings ●, no cut list
TALKING TO OTHER GEAR	Pro DJ Link, StageLinQ, Link, MIDI clock, SMPTE	tally, GPI, timecode, MOS	MIDI in only

The DJ's clock

Videoboy already thinks in beats: BPM, DIV, BEAT, quantised pads and sweeps, a neural beat tracker on any app's audio. What it lacks from DJing is **preparation inside the media**: hot cues, loops in beats, slip.

The switcher's discipline

Bus keys, Hot Punch ("hot punching" is cutting directly on the program bus), A/B ROLL, tally and ISO recording are broadcast behaviour. What it lacks is **memory**: E-MEMs, a DSK, a rundown, and the edit export.

The editor's afterlife

Three-point editing, splice-in vs overwrite, markers and EDL/XML interchange are how a broadcast editor thinks. Videoboy already shares the source-monitor half; a **cut list** gives it the record half.

Sources: ATEM manual · GV Kayenne concepts · NYFA · Rundown Creator · EVS LSM manual · CasparCG · rekordbox 7 · DJ glossaries · Videomaker / Zettl (01-broadcast-and-dj-deep-dive.md)

DEEP DIVE · WHAT TO BORROW

Twelve borrowings, ranked by what they unlock.

§	BORROW	FROM	SIZE	WHAT IT IS
5.1	**Hot cues per clip**	DJ	M	8 coloured cues in the catalog, beat-quantised jumps, later auto-placed at shot changes
5.2	**Cut list with every recording**	Broadcast	S–M	EDL + FCPXML beside the ISO files: the ATEM ISO idea without a .drp
5.3	**Look memories (E-MEM)**	Broadcast	M	learn / recall in one press, numbered slots, partial recall; obeys LOCK
5.4	**Downstream key layer**	Broadcast	M	own CUT / AUTO / rate after Program for titles, Now Playing, Scala, logos
5.5	**One title model**	Broadcast	S	PLAY animates in, NEXT steps, STOP animates out, UPDATE swaps data
5.6	**Beat from DJ gear**	DJ	M each	MIDI clock in, then Ableton Link; Pro DJ Link / StageLinQ only for track data
5.7	**Preview discipline**	Both	S–M	CUE key per source (PFL), optional Program/Preview on 1/2, tally out over MIDI
5.8	**Rates, DIP, stingers, soft edges**	Broadcast	S–M	a rate per transition style; DIP to colour; alpha-clip stingers; soft wipes
5.9	**Loops in beats, roll, slip**	DJ	M	1/4–16 beat loops, momentary roll, slip for any momentary action
5.10	**Rundown with back-timing**	Broadcast	M	Setlists with lengths, back-timed from a show end time
5.11	**Controller ergonomics**	DJ	S each	Center Lock on bipolar knobs, fader curves, kill switches, MIDI LED feedback
5.12	**Audio-linked FX presets**	DJ video	S	Serato's idea: onset → Freeze pulse, lows → feedback zoom, in one click

Not recommended

Audio output (the app is silent by design; DJs own audio), a full NLE timeline (the cut list gets the benefit), a newsroom / MOS integration (a different product).

Rule 1 · behaviours, not looks

Every item is about how a performer cues, takes and remembers. The look stays analog, bitstream and NTSC.

Rule 2 · profiles, not clutter

New behaviour arrives as states of existing keys or as modes on the mode bar, never as floating panels. S ≈ a day, M ≈ a few days.

Source: docs/research/2026-10-01/01-broadcast-and-dj-deep-dive.md §5–6

VOCABULARY · THREE WORLDS

Most of Videoboy's words already mean the right thing.

✓ same meaning ≈ close relative ⚠ false friend

VIDEOBOY	DJ	BROADCAST NEWS
Source A–D	deck ≈	input / source ✓
Bank (A/B, C/D)	deck layer ≈	M/E bank ✓
Sub Mix · ONE / TWO	the two-deck mix ≈	M/E · ME1 / ME2 ✓
Program	master ≈	Program (PGM) ✓
CUT	cut ✓	CUT ✓
FADE	crossfade ✓	AUTO / MIX ≈
BEAT	quantize ≈	—
crossfader	crossfader ✓	T-bar ≈
transition key · AVE-5	—	transition style · wipes ✓
Hot Punch (!)	—	hot punching ✓
ROLL	loop roll ⚠	A/B roll · roll VT ✓
ADV	auto-load next ≈	next playlist item ≈
tally	ON AIR ✓	tally ✓

VIDEOBOY	DJ	BROADCAST NEWS
Queue · Play Next / Last	queue ✓	clip-server playlist ≈
Clip Pads	sampler pads ≈ · hot-cue pads ⚠	—
AUTO (library)	auto-play ≈	AUTO transition ⚠
bin · catalog	crate · collection ✓	bin · MAM ✓
focus A · B · MIX	Beat FX channel select ✓	—
rate key	beat select ✓	transition RATE ✓
CLOCK · Detect · Learn	sync source · analyse · MIDI learn ✓	reference · — · panel map ≈
DATA BURN · FILE / TC	—	burn-in · UMD ✓
Safe · Overscan · Test Pat	—	safe area · overscan · bars ✓
Setlist (planned)	setlist = song order ⚠	E-MEM ≈
LOCK (planned)	LOAD LOCK ✓	panel lock ✓
TAKE (EMU)	—	TAKE = put on air ⚠ · CG UPDATE

Source: docs/research/2026-10-01/02-vocabulary.md (terms from App/Sources UI strings) · DJ glossaries · ATEM, Kayenne, Zettl, CDJ-3000 manual

VOCABULARY · FALSE FRIENDS

Eight words that will trip someone up.

SETLIST

To every DJ and band a setlist is the running order of songs. Videoboy's is one bank's state — the broadcast E-MEM.

Fix: Keep (owner-set). Tooltip: "a bank's look". Watch for confusion; Scene, Look or Memory are the fallbacks.

AUTO (LIBRARY)

Means autoplay-on-load here; on a switcher AUTO runs the transition.

Fix: AUTOPLAY, or a ▶ glyph.

TAKE (EMU)

Repaints the Amiga's page here; broadcast TAKE puts the next element on air.

Fix: UPDATE (the CG word for exactly this) or SEND.

ROLL

Right for broadcast (A/B roll, roll VT); a DJ's loop roll is a momentary stutter.

Fix: Keep; if loop roll ships, call it STUTTER.

CLIP PADS

Launch whole clips; DJs expect pads to be hot cues inside a track.

Fix: When hot cues ship, give the pads modes: Clips · Cues.

DETECT

UI: beat detection. SPEC §7 and DetectSession still call MIDI learn "shift-to-detect".

Fix: Docs say Learn; code names can follow.

VJ (MODE)

CLAUDE.md says Videoboy is not a VJ tool, and the owner wants a room for many creatives.

Fix: LIVE (or SHOW), beside IMPORT and SETTINGS.

FADE

Broadcast users look for AUTO beside CUT.

Fix: Keep FADE; tooltip "(AUTO on a switcher)".

The cheap fix for all of them

Put the other worlds' words in the tooltips, the way the AVE-5 popover quotes the hardware manual: *"FADE — an automatic transition at the FADE rate (AUTO on a switcher, a blend on a DJ mixer)."* Nothing moves, nobody relearns anything, and a DJ or a TD finds their own word under the pointer.

Source: 02-vocabulary.md §5 · App/Sources/Videoboy/UI (LibraryPanelBody AUTO, EmuBrowserView TAKE) · docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-28-setlist.md

THE ROADMAP — AS THE OWNER HAS SET IT

LOCK, Playlists, Setlists, songs. Then any canvas, then tags.

Everything on this page comes from the project's planning documents, which the owner approved or set — the build plan, the two proposals, the backlogs and the flag notes — with their dates and estimates. None of it is the author's opinion.

SEP 2026
SHIPPED

- 0.4.6 decode fixes · 0.4.7 SQLite catalog + background import
- 0.4.8 mode bar + setup assistant · 0.4.9 Import mode
- 0.4.10 Copy + Optimize (linked optimized media)
- A/B ROLL + ADV · Clip Pads · Hot Punch · FX focus A·B·MIX
- take-backs · one rule for every beat-rate key · nested bins
- BeatNet beat detection · DV removed (MPEG-family wedge)

1 OCT 2026
NOW

- Queue names: Playlist → Queue, Play Next / Play Last
- Queues saved with the show (template v5)
- branch feature/queue-names (setlist plan, phase 0)

SETLIST PLAN
NEXT

- 1 · LOCK per bank (~1½ days)
- 2 · Playlists + Lists tab, Append / Replace (~1½ days)
- 3 · Setlists: bank state, Start Up Sequence Punch / Cue / Crossfade (~3½ days)
- 4 · Song linking to Apple Music (~1½ days)

0.4.11 → 0.5.0
THEN

- 0.4.11 any canvas: SD PAL, HD, square, vertical; 23.976–30 fps; ½-res fallback
- 0.5.0 tags: tag pools → Queues, tag pads, beat shuffle, energy fader, smart bins

BACKLOG
ALSO ASKED FOR

- WeatherStar 3000/4000 under EMU · Amiberry IPC save states
- retro emulation library + TAS · custom shader injection
- Colour Ctrl + Layer Mask cards · generator colour wells
- beat ×2 / ÷2, downbeat, nudge · MIDI clock + Link · Syphon out
- Copy+Optimize Custom preset · ROLL/ADV on Program · Macros & AI

DECISIONS
OPEN

- Lists tab name · Setlists copy or point to Playlists
- pads hide first, LOCK never · Hot Punch show-wide?
- bitstream corruptor stays off until judged on an analog chain
- 1.0 / public beta plan exists only in chat

THE SETLIST PLAN BY ITS OWN ESTIMATES — ABOUT 8½ DAYS IN ALL



0.4.11 (any canvas) ~2.5k lines and 0.5.0 (tags) ~1.8k lines, per PROPOSAL-2026-09-26 §9.

> From the setlist proposal (owner-set 2026-09-29): "Each word has one meaning." LOCK comes first "because it doesn't depend on anything else, it's useful the day it ships, and it's what makes an automatic song trigger safe to use."

> From the corruptor's flag comment in VideoboyCore.swift: "It is off rather than deleted … Whatever it becomes next will start from the working version rather than from a rewrite."

Sources: docs/BUILD-PLAN.md · docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-26.md §9 · docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-28-setlist.md §1, §9–10 · docs/FEATURE-LEDGER-2026-09-27.md · VideoboyCore.swift

WHAT I WOULD DO · AS A GENERALIST

Make the wedge undeniable, then open the doors.

1 · Turn the wedge back on

- The MPEG corruptor — the reason the app exists — ships switched off because nobody can judge it without an analog chain.
- Build the judging rig into the app: Program → HDMI→RCA → DVC100 → capture → a side-by-side monitor. The self-QA loopback already does the hard part.
- Ship it as an Experimental card the day it can be judged.

2 · Trust before features

- Undo for parameter changes and loads (the owner called its absence "a consistent bug").
- LOCK as designed, then hot cues.
- Write the 1.0 bar that exists only in chat: per-canvas stress and soak gates, a person's click-through of every mode, a manual, crash reports.

3 · Plumbing that multiplies

- Syphon out, OSC in/out, MIDI clock and Ableton Link. Days each, not weeks.
- Each one lets Videoboy join rigs it will never replace: Resolume, VDMX, QLab, Ableton, the booth.

4 · Name it for what it is

- Rename the VJ mode to LIVE; fix AUTO, TAKE and the docs' "detect".
- Put DJ and broadcast synonyms in every tooltip.
- Lead every description with the wedge and the analog output, not the mixer.

5 · Protect the code

- Split ShellController (3,116 lines in September, 3,778 today) into a controller per mode, as the 09-26 proposal planned.
- Refresh STATUS.md and TODO.md, which describe v0.4.0.
- Make build scripts fail loudly instead of rebuilding a signing keychain they cannot read — a sandboxed build check on 2026-10-01 deleted it.

WHAT I WOULD NOT BUILD

- projection mapping, warping or edge blending
- audio output
- 3-D or a generative node graph
- floating or dockable panels
- a full NLE timeline
- DMX or lighting

RISKS I WOULD WATCH

Scope creep	every gap closed for one audience widens the app; the wedge must stay the reason to buy
A narrow niche	SD-first and Mac-only (Apple Silicon) is a feature for the core user and a ceiling for growth
Frame budget at HD	0.4.11 multiplies pixels ~6×; the ½-resolution fallback is the safety net
Distribution	no signing or notarization today; nobody else can run a release
One maintainer	80k lines written largely by AI sessions — the docs and 867 tests are the insurance

THE ONE-LINE VERSION

Make the wedge undeniable, make the app trustworthy, and wire it into other people's rigs — before adding anything that only widens it.

The author's view. Facts from: VideoboyCore.swift (flags) · BUILD-PLAN take-backs entry · FEATURE-LEDGER §4 · PROPOSAL-2026-09-26 §6, §10 · wc -l ShellController.swift

WHAT I WOULD DO · MARKET AND MONEY

Sell the instrument. License the sound.

POSITION

Sell the instrument

Don't fight Resolume on breadth. Own **"the analog instrument"**: musicians and DJs who want pictures with character, video artists, music-video directors, streamers chasing tape. Lead with the wedge, the NTSC chain and the vintage titler — the three things no competitor has.

PRICE

Copy the model VJs already accept

- Perpetual licence around **$249** with 12 months of updates; renewal around **$79** (the Resolume / Synesthesia pattern).
- Education at 50% (Resolume's rate).
- Tour rental around **$29 a week** per machine (Millumin's precedent).
- A free, watermarked demo (Resolume, MadMapper and Synesthesia all have one).

LICENSE THE SOUND

The engine may be worth more than the app

- **Plug-ins for editors:** the NTSC composite model and the datamosh as FxPlug (Final Cut, Motion), OFX (Resolve) and Premiere effects. The editing audience is far larger than the VJ audience.
- **An ISF / FFGL pack** for Resolume, VDMX and MadMapper users.
- **OEM to DJ software:** audio-linked video FX is Serato Video's pitch; a real bitstream datamosh locked to the beat is not in any DJ app's documented effects.

ILLUSTRATIVE ARITHMETIC — SIZES THE DECISION, NOT A FORECAST

LINE	UNITS / YR	PRICE	REVENUE / YR
App licences	1,000	$249	$249,000
Renewals (40% of base)	400	$79	$31,600
Editor plug-in	3,000	$99	$297,000
Tour rentals	300 weeks	$29	$8,700

Units are placeholders chosen to show proportions: a plug-in line could rival the app on a fraction of the effort. No market-size data was found that would make these a forecast.

WHO BUYS FIRST, AND WHERE TO FIND THEM

- **Musicians who perform with visuals** — through the gear they already own: capture boxes, HDMI→RCA converters, MIDI controllers.
- **Glitch and tape artists** — where the looks travel: short video, art-school workshops, festival VJ lineups.
- **DJs adding a screen** — via song linking with Apple Music now, the booth's protocols later.
- **Editors** — via the plug-in, which then sells the app.

BEFORE ANY SALE

- **Distribution needs Developer ID signing and notarization** — CLAUDE.md currently rules both out. That is the first business decision.
- Licences are in order and must stay so: FFmpeg built LGPL-only (the build fails on GPL), BeatNet weights CC BY 4.0 with attribution shipped, Amiberry (GPL) out of process, ROMs and disks user-supplied.
- Apple Music / Spotify features need the user's Automation permission; say so up front.

The author's view. Price anchors: resolume.com/shop · synesthesia.live/pricing · millumin.com/v5 · docs/THIRD-PARTY.md · CLAUDE.md

WHAT I WOULD DO · AS A VIDEO ARTIST CUTTING LIVE TO A SHOW

Prepare like an editor. Perform like a DJ. Deliver like a broadcaster.

BEFORE THE SHOW

- Import with Copy + Optimize (MPEG-2 GOP 6) so every clip is wedge-ready and loops cleanly.
- Mark the shots that matter (today: in/out; with hot cues: eight per clip).
- One Setlist per song: two Playlists, the bank's FX and pads; link each to its song in Music.
- Pads 1–8 hold the hit shots: logo, strobe, crowd, the one perfect frame.

SOUNDCHECK

- CLOCK = the DJ's app or System Audio; Detect until it locks; fix 3:2 locks (×2 / ÷2 wanted).
- Program to the HDMI→RCA chain; check legality on the scopes.
- Arm REC: Program + A/B/C/D, one folder per take.
- LOCK the bank you won't touch (planned).

THE SHOW

- Verses: FADE between 1 and 2, beat-quantised. Choruses: CUT on the bar.
- A/B ROLL keeps both sources rolling so every cut lands on moving footage; ADV feeds the next clip from the Queue.
- Hits: Hot Punch a pad straight to air.
- Drops: hold MOSH for a bar, HEAL on the downbeat.
- Song changes: the linked Setlist lands on the off-air bank and Punches in; Now Playing fades its lower third.

AFTER

- The take folder holds Program and every source.
- With a cut list (EDL / FCPXML) the night becomes a timeline in Resolve or Premiere — re-cut, colour, deliver.
- DATA BURN a reference copy with timecode for the band.

WHAT I'D BUILD FOR THIS PERSON, IN ORDER

1. Hot cues, and a Cues mode on the pads
2. CUE-to-preview per source (DJ PFL)
3. Cut list export with the ISO files
4. Tally and armed states on the controller's LEDs (MIDI out)
5. "Next song ready" in the Setlist strip
6. ×2 / ÷2 and a downbeat nudge beside the tempo

ILLUSTRATIVE CUE SHEET — THREE FICTIONAL SONGS

SONG	BPM	SETLIST (BANK)	START UP	SOURCES AND PADS	MOMENTS
1 · Opener	128	Neon (A/B)	Punch	A: tunnel loop · B: crowd plates · pads: logo, strobe	bar 1 Punch in · bar 17 FADE 1→2 · drop (bar 33): MOSH 1 bar, HEAL on the downbeat
2 · Ballad	84	Tape (C/D)	Cue	C: home movies · D: photo folder, STEP 1/2	Composite NTSC heavy · 4-bar FADE · Now Playing lower third on entry
3 · Closer	174 (½-time 87)	Glitch (A/B)	Crossfade	A: datamosh source · B: performance cam	check ×2 / ÷2 · Hot Punch pads on hits · AVE-5 wipe into the last chorus · keep recording

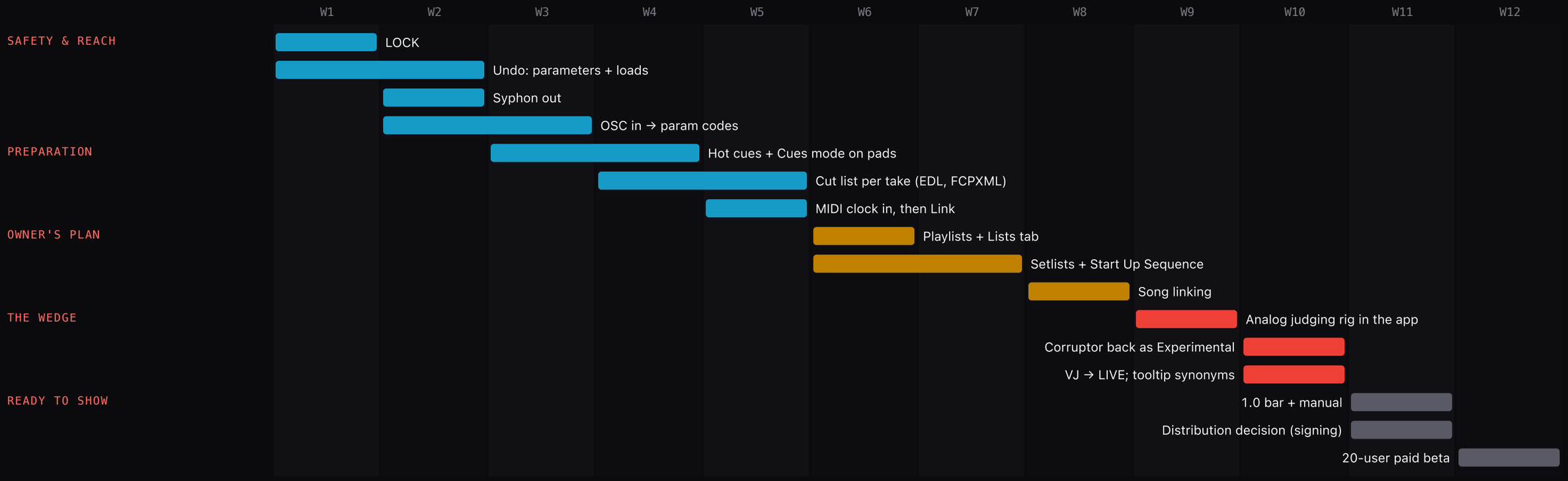
Why Videoboy fits: Resolume and VDMX cut to the beat but think in clips and layers; vMix and ATEM cut a programme without a beat; DJ apps own the beat only for video glued to tracks. Videoboy has the beat clock, broadcast takes and ISO recording in one room.

The author's view, using shipped features (inventory) and the owner's planned Setlist / LOCK / song-linking design · the cue sheet is illustrative

WHAT I WOULD DO · THE FIRST 90 DAYS

Twelve weeks, in this order.

■ safety, reach, preparation ■ the owner's plan ■ the wedge ■ ready to show · bars are labelled directly



WHERE THIS AGREES WITH THE OWNER

LOCK first, then Playlists, Setlists and songs, in the owner's order and with the owner's design. Any canvas (0.4.11) and tags (0.5.0) keep their places after it.

WHERE IT DIFFERS

It puts undo, Syphon, OSC, hot cues and the cut list **before** Setlists, because they serve every audience at once; and it brings the corruptor back sooner, because the wedge is the only thing a buyer can't get elsewhere.

The author's plan · owner-plan durations from the setlist proposal (LOCK ~1½ d, Playlists ~1½ d, Setlists ~3½ d, songs ~1½ d); others are the author's estimates

METHOD AND VERIFICATION

How this was checked — and what the re-check caught.

VIDEOBOY INVENTORY

130 features read from the source on branch feature/queue-names (a92f464). STATUS.md (v0.4.0) and TODO.md (audit L8) are stale, so documents were only used to find features, never to confirm them.

119 path references tested for existence by script: all resolve. Status counts are grep counts.

Matrix cross-check: every Videoboy cell cites inventory rows and is tested by build_deck.py — 45 cells, 0 disagreements.

COMPETITORS

Vendor documentation, support pages and price pages fetched on 2026-10-01 for Resolume, VDMX, Millumin, QLab, MadMapper, TouchDesigner, Synesthesia, Serato, VirtualDJ, vMix, Blackmagic, Adobe and Apple; a second round targeted the uncertain cells.

72 of 406 competitor cells remain **?** — shown, not guessed. Secondary sources are marked *.

LIMITS

No competitor was installed or tested hands-on; "not found in the documentation reviewed" is not proof of absence. No market-size figure is sourced; the revenue table is illustrative. Prices are as published on 2026-10-01, unconverted. Wireframes are schematic. Opinion is labelled.

THE RE-CHECK LOG

CHECKED	HOW	WHAT THE RE-CHECK CHANGED
Inventory rows	code read · grep counts · path test	3 rows corrected (Transform position, Colour controls, Settings panes); 3 absent features added; first hand-count of totals replaced by a machine count
Matrix: Videoboy cells	rule check against cited inventory rows	undo ◐→–; 4 rows re-cited; 45 cells, 0 disagreements
Matrix: competitor cells	vendor docs, then a targeted second round	Link, MIDI clock, NDI, Syphon, recording, undo, HAP, cue lists, scopes resolved; ATEM scopes –→?; the rest shown as ?
Research documents	second read against sources	Premiere doesn't import FCPXML (fixed); recording-effects claim made neutral; Synesthesia BPM and Resolume blend count softened
Deck headlines and copy	page-by-page review of the rendered PDF	"everyone else rents", VirtualDJ "subscription only", "only Resolve", scoreboard leaders, roadmap quote attribution, product count 15→14

SOURCES

VIDEOBOY (REPO)

CLAUDE.md
docs/SPEC.md
docs/BUILD-PLAN.md
docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-26.md
docs/PROPOSAL-2026-09-28-setlist.md
docs/FEATURE-LEDGER-2026-09-27.md
docs/AUDIT-2026-09-28.md
docs/THIRD-PARTY.md
docs/DESIGN-BACKLOG.md
docs/REQUEST-BACKLOG.md
docs/research/2026-10-01/feature-inventory.md
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RESOLUME

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https://resolume.com/support
https://resolume.com/support/en/clips
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https://resolume.com/support/en/updates
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https://www.resolume.com/blog/23542
https://github.com/stoatworks-labs/resolume-scopes
https://vjacademy.info/learn/resolume-arena-vs-avenue

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https://cdm.link/madmapper-6-brings-timelines-markers-clips-more/
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OTHER LIVE TOOLS

https://hap.video/integrations.html
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https://imimot.com/blog/farewell-from-coge/
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https://djworx.com/stagelinq-soundswitch-resolume-denon-djs-visual-trinity/
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POST AND DAW

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All fetched or searched on 2026-10-01 unless noted · * = secondary source

VIDEOBOY

Make the wedge undeniable. Make the app trustworthy. Wire it into other people's rigs.

Research files: docs/research/2026-10-01/ in the videoboy-perf worktree · source of this deck: deck/build_deck.py